



**Verified Carbon
Standard**

VERIFICATION REPORT FOR DELAGUA IMPROVED COOKSTOVE GROUPED PROJECT



SUSTAINCERT

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Summary:

A description of the verification of the project

The Verification of the project titled 'DelAgua Improved Cookstove Grouped Project' VCS ID – 3699, have been undertaken by SustainCERT, with accordance to the relevant VCS standard/1/, VCS Program Guide/2/. Relevant requirements of the ISO 14064-2 and ISO 14064-3, as well as applicable criteria for consistent project operations, monitoring and reporting has been applied for verification.

The project VCS 3699 involves dissemination of cookstoves in Rwanda under one project instance. The project is a voluntary initiative as host country laws do not mandate the distribution of ICS to the households. The project proponent is DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) who are using carbon finance to support local partners engaged in different activities like production, distribution, and maintenance of various product technologies. The ICSs disseminated under the grouped project are based on a "rocket stove" and designed to improve fuel combustion and heat transfer which by rocket stove design principles reduces the use of biomass fuel through improved combustion efficiency of wood fuel.

The Purpose and scope of verification

Purpose:

Verification service provided by SustainCERT for project activity 3699 is to perform independent periodic verification for the monitoring period 01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024. The verification of the project is an independent review and ex-post determination by SustainCERT of the monitored reductions in GHG emissions that have occurred, against the VCS standard/1/, VCS Program Guide/2/, the Project baseline and host party criteria.

Scope of verification

The scope of verification is to establish/verify that:

- Methodology change from VMR0006 Methodology for Installation of High Efficiency Firewood Cookstoves v1.1. to VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0
- The project activity has been implemented and operated as per the changed methodology.

- All the physical features (project technology) of the project are in place in accordance with registered PD and VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0.
- The monitoring report and other supporting documents provided are complete in accordance with the latest applicable version of VCS standard.
- The actual monitoring systems and procedures comply with the monitoring systems and procedures described in the monitoring plan, any registered monitoring plan, the changed methodology including applicable tool(s) and/or, where applicable, the reassessed baseline.
- The data recorded and stored as per the monitoring methodology including applicable tool(s) and, where applicable, the reassessed baseline

The Monitoring Period:

The project activity VCS 3699 is undergoing 2nd verification from 01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024 (both days included), under its first crediting period (7 years) from 04/11/2022 to 03/11/2029.

The Method and Criteria used for Verification.

Desk Review:

Review of project information, monitoring plan specifically monitoring frequency, quality assurance and quality control system against the registered PD/5/ and applicable VCS standard and applied methodology VCS Methodology from Sectoral Scope 3 – VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0

- Onsite audit Interview with the relevant personnel to confirm the implementation of the project with paying particular attention to the operational and data collection procedures, in accordance with the registered PD/5/ and changed methodology.
- A detailed cross check of the information provided in the monitoring report against the relevant evidence such as data sources, technical specification of measuring equipment.
- A detailed cross check of the calculations made for the estimation of greenhouse gas emissions.
- An evaluation of data management and the quality assurance and quality control system in the context of their influence on the generation and reporting of emissions reduction.

The number of findings raised during verification:

A risk-based approach has been followed for the verification of the project. During verification, 02 CARs, 14 CL and 00 FAR were raised during verification.

All the issues raised were resolved successfully, details for which can be found in appendix 4 of the report.

Any uncertainties associated with the verification:

The assessment team thoroughly reviewed monitoring report and the emission reduction calculation sheet against the relevant evidence and applicable VCS requirements, VCS standard V4.7/1/ and VCS guideline V4.4. It has been concluded that there are no more uncertainties associated with the project.

Summary of the verification conclusion:

The review of revised PDD, monitoring report/8/, emission reduction calculation sheet along with relevant supporting evidence and the interview with relevant personnel during on site audit have provided the assessment team with sufficient evidence to confirm to the applicable criteria. The SustainCERT confirms the project activity VCS 3699 have been successfully implemented in accordance with the registered PD/5/, revised PD /41/ and updated methodology VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0 meeting all the relevant VCS requirements. SustainCERT confirms that the monitoring period 01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024 (including both the days) in its implementation is calculated to generate 1,911,382 tCO₂e of emission reductions from reducing the amount of wood fuel combustion.

The management of DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) (=Project Proponent) is responsible for the preparation of the GHG emissions data and the reported GHG emission reductions on the basis set out within the project's Monitoring Plan indicated in the registered Project Design and the updated methodology.

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1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Objective

The Verification of the project titled “DelAgua Improved Cookstove Grouped Project” VCS ID – 3699, have been undertaken by SustainCERT, as requested by DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) project proponent for the monitoring period 01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024 (including both the days). The verification of project activity is the 2nd periodic verification for the crediting period 04/11/2022 to 03/11/2029. The purpose of the verification is to conduct an independent review of the project information and confirm:

- The project activity is implemented in accordance with registered project description document/5/, revised PD /41/ and updated methodology.
- All physical features (project technology) are in place.
- The actual monitoring systems and procedures comply with the monitoring systems and procedures described in the monitoring plan, the updated methodology including applicable tool(s) and/or, where applicable, the reassessed baseline.
- The data collection procedures and records are as per the monitoring methodology VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0/7/

The verification followed the requirements mentioned in the VCS standard/1/ and VCS Guidelines/2/ ensuring the quality and consistency of the report.

1.2 Scope and Criteria

The scope of verification for this project activity involves assessing the claims made by the project proponent in the monitoring report/8/, emission reduction calculation sheet/9/ and other supporting evidence (as mentioned in appendix 2) made available to the verifier for this monitoring period from 01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024, in accordance to:

- VCS standard/1/
- VCS program guideline/2/
- VCS Methodology from Sectoral Scope 3 – VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0/7/
- Other relevant rules and requirements, including host part requirements/30/.

A risk-based approach has been followed for the verification of the project activity. Identifying and assessing the high-risk area and ensuring the reliability of the project's emission reductions generated.

The principles of accuracy, completeness, relevance, reliability and credibility were combined with a conservative approach to establish a traceable and transparent verification opinion. The verification considers both quantitative and qualitative information on emission reductions. The verification is not meant to provide any consultancy towards the client. However, stated requests for clarifications, corrective and/or forward actions may provide input for improvement of the monitoring activities.

1.3 Level of Assurance

The verification of the project activity is conducted by doing a thorough assessment of Monitoring report/8/, Registered PD/5/, revised PD/41/ emission reduction calculation sheet/9/ and all the relevant documents mentioned Kitchen Performance Test, and Distribution Database' (as mentioned in appendix 2) of the report.

The level of assurance achieved for the project verification falls under a reasonable level of assurance. A reasonable level of assurance is high level of assurance regarding material misstatement, but not an absolute one.

Enough evidence were gathered by the assessment team to reduce the risk associated with audit process. This means that there is some uncertainty arising from the use of sampling since it is possible that a material misstatement is missed.

1.4 Summary Description of the Project

This is the 2nd monitoring report for the "DelAgua Improved Cookstove Grouped Project" (VCS ID 3699), Grouped Project ("GP") by DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) which is aimed at distributing fuel-efficient improved cookstoves (ICS) to local communities in Rwanda.

The ICS disseminated under this GP is based on rocket stove design principles, which reduce GHG emissions from biomass burning through improved combustion efficiency of wood fuel and decreased wood fuel consumption.

202,965 units Kuniokoa Generation 2 stoves were distributed in this monitoring period. Since the project start date, a total of 335,313/11/ units have been distributed.

	Distributed units in MP1 (04/11/2022 – 31/12/2022)	Distributed units in this MP2 (01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024)	Total cookstoves distributed (units)
PAI1	132,348	202,965	335,313
Total	132,348	202,965	335,313

Technical specification of the stove technology is verified in accordance with registered PD section 1.11, manufacturer's specifications/36/.

An onsite audit for the project activity was conducted from 18/03/2025 to 21/03/2025. Interviews of the PP representatives were conducted through Video call to ensure the implementation of the project activity. Furthermore, it was confirmed that the project involves supply of dissemination of improved cookstoves for period 01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024, leading to 1,911,382 tCO₂e/9/ emission reductions.

The start date of the project activity is 04/11/2022 for PAI1/6/ with no other PAI has been implemented so far in the GP. This was verified from the opening meeting, verification against distribution database/11/ and by cross verifying against previous monitoring period reports and verification reports. The crediting period for the project activity is 04/11/2022 to 03/11/2029, as verified using PD/5/, validation report/6/ and onsite visit/10/.

Based on this, the assessment team confirms that the project activity VCS 3699 'DeLaGua Improved Cookstove Grouped Project' is implemented and operational in accordance with applied methodology VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0/7/, Project Description Document/5/, VCS standard/1/ and VCS guidelines/2/. It has also been assessed and verified that emission reduction calculation for this monitoring period from 01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024 has been done conservatively and found to be appropriate.

2 VERIFICATION PROCESS

The Registered Project activity has been undergoing 2nd Verification under its first crediting period (7 years), the approach adapted to ensure the quality and credibility of emission reduction is described in the following sections.

2.1 Method and Criteria

The method and criteria used for verification consist of the following phases. A risk-based approach has been applied for the process.

Desk review:

A document review of the monitoring report/8/, emission reduction calculation sheet and other evidence like monitoring survey data/12/, signed user agreements/14/, project distribution database/11/ (as mentioned in Appendix 2 of the report) were strategically reviewed and risk assessment was undertaken.

- Project activity sources contributing to the leakage as well as project emissions are assessed.
- The frequency of measurements, QA/QC procedures and other relevant documents are verified.
- An onsite audit for the project was conducted from 18/03/2025 to 21/03/2025. Further details regarding the process have been mentioned in sections 2.3 and 2.4 of the report.
- Interviews of the project representatives were conducted to discuss the implementation and operational status of the project with respect to the registered monitoring plan/5/ and updated methodology.
- Discussion of QA/QC procedure, data collection, storage and transfer.
- Interview and visual observation on the condition of the project technology stove, baseline stoves, perceived opinion on SDG claims of the projects, grievances if any
- Monitoring period claimed (01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024) was verified from the ER calculation/9/, as well as from the previous monitoring period/5/ and its verification report/6/ to ensure that the period claimed is continuing from the last monitoring period and no double claim made.

During verification, 02 CARs, 14 CL and 00 FAR were raised during verification. Resolution of all the issues and findings raised was done, and the final verification statement was issued.

2.2 Document Review

As part of verification of the project, the primary activity performed was the strategic review and risk assessment of the documents submitted using a dedicated protocol. A detailed review of MR/8/ and ER calculation/9/ was performed to check:

The completeness of the information with reference to the register PD/5/, revised PD/41/ and updated methodology/7/.

Review of project information, monitoring plan specifically monitoring frequency, quality assurance and quality control system against the registered PD/5/ and applicable VCS standard and updated methodology version 1.0.

A review of the QA/QC procedures were conducted to make sure the implementation is as per the revised PD/41/ and updated methodology.

Project specific assessment against applicable national framework and legislation requirement/30/31/32/.

All the other evidence reviewed is mentioned in Appendix 2 of this report. The cross checks between information provided in the Monitoring report/08/, VM0050/7/ and information from sources other than those used, if available, the team's sectoral or local expertise and, if necessary, independent background investigations.

2.3 Interviews

An on-site inspection/10/ was performed by the assessment team for the project and baseline reassessment in accordance with updated methodology.

Table 1: Project technology users interviewed on site for household visit

No	Stove barcode	End-User name	Type of correspondent	Cluster/village	Date of Audit
1	MQ040643	Dusabimana Jakerine	Household	Huye	18/03/2025
2	MQ047526	Havugarurema Pascal	Household	Huye	18/03/2025
3	MQ014340	Mukamurenzi Alice	Household	Huye	18/03/2025
4	MQ119730	Dukundane Marie Claire	Household	Huye	18/03/2025
5	MQ198038	Vuguziga Samuel	Household	Huye	18/03/2025
6	MQ295285	Bosenibamwe ancille	Household	Nyabihu	21/03/2025
7	MQ279329	Niyitegeka	Household	Nyabihu	21/03/2025
8	MQ331104	Maniriho Ernest	Household	Nyabihu	21/03/2025

Table 2: Baseline stove users interviewed on site for household visit

S.No	End-User name	Type of correspondent	Cluster/village	Date of Audit
1	Kamanzi Felix	Household	Ruhango	19/03/2025
2	Uwimana Beatrice	Household	Ruhango	19/03/2025
3	Mukantwari Rahab	Household	Ruhango	19/03/2025
4	Semakuba Leopard	Household	Ruhango	19/03/2025

5	Nzagayimana Oscar	Household	Ruhango	19/03/2025
6	Mukazabarande Jacqueline	Household	Musanze	20/03/2025
7	Dusabemariya Vestine	Household	Musanze	20/03/2025
8	Nyirabukara Berthe	Household	Musanze	20/03/2025

Tables 1, 2 ,3 & 4 provide a comprehensive overview of the onsite interview process conducted during the verification.

The tables outline the personnel involved in the interviews, along with their respective roles. The interviews specifically targeted individuals responsible for monitoring the project activity, data collection and management, as well as those involved in the quality assurance and quality control (QA/QC) procedures. The tables serve to identify the individuals interviewed and provide relevant information regarding their roles within the project. Manika Mongia (Team Leader, Technical expert) led the project, opening and closing meeting for the project along with Indrapal Parmar (Auditor, Technical expert) and Jean Bosco (Auditor, Technical expert, country expert). Jean Bosco performed onsite visit and submitted the report to the team leader.

The key personnel interviewed during the opening meeting and closing meeting session of the onsite audit, and the main topics of the interviews are summarized in the table below:

Site visit was emphasized on project technology user with visit to each household for visual observation as well as verbal confirmation on parameter of:

- Project technology usage
- Project technology model and overall condition (repairs/maintenance)
- Project unique identification barcode
- Baseline stove and baseline fuel
- Confirmation regarding the end user agreements and carbon transfer rights
- Perception on smoke level of project technology vs baseline stove

During the site visit, verifier team has interviewed with PP's representative and implementation partners employed monitoring teams. Interviews were conducted as part of the verification process for data collection and storage for data sets of distribution database/11/and monitoring survey/12/. The list of interviewed personals are as followed:

Table 3: Project implementation field team interviewed from 18/03/2025 to 21/03/2025

S.No	Name of the person Interviewed	Affiliation	Details Discussed	Audit Team
1	Hakizimana Musa (Data and system analyst)	DelAgua	Project monitoring survey execution, project distribution mechanism, data collection (distribution database), grievances mechanism	Jean Bosco Rwiyamirira (Auditor, Country Expert)
2	Kabagire Smalagda (H.C.W)	DelAgua	Project monitoring survey execution, project distribution mechanism, data collection (distribution database), grievances mechanism	Jean Bosco Rwiyamirira (Auditor, Country Expert)
3	Kayihura Athanase (H.C.W)	DelAgua	Project monitoring survey execution, project distribution mechanism, data collection (distribution database), grievances mechanism	Jean Bosco Rwiyamirira (Auditor, Country Expert)
4	Kwizera Olivier (Data Analyst)	DelAgua	Project monitoring survey execution, project distribution mechanism, data collection (distribution database), grievances mechanism	Jean Bosco Rwiyamirira (Auditor, Country Expert)
5	Jacques Bizimungu (CHW)	DelAgua	Project monitoring survey execution, project distribution mechanism, data collection (distribution database), grievances mechanism	Jean Bosco Rwiyamirira (Auditor, Country Expert)
6	Theophile Maniriho (CHW)	DelAgua	Project monitoring survey execution, project distribution mechanism, data collection (distribution database), grievances mechanism	Jean Bosco Rwiyamirira (Auditor, Country Expert)

The list of PP representatives interviewed by the VVB team during the opening meeting is as followed:

Table 4: List of PP representatives

S.No	Name of the person interviewed	Affiliation	Details Discussed	Audit Team
1	David Kitt	DelAgua	Project implementation and operation, Project design, monitoring procedure, data and information flow, compliance of monitoring	Manika Mongia (Team Leader, Technical expert); Indrapal Parmar (Auditor, technical expert); Jean Bosco (Auditor, technical expert, country expert);
2	Ashutosh Tiwari	DelAgua	plan with monitoring methodology and approved VCS-PD, Roles and responsibility, Qualification and Training, VCU calculation and completeness of monitoring report, Electronic Monitoring system, Data collection and data flow, Monitoring surveys, Sample size	

2.4 Site Visits

The VVB carried out an on-site visit from 18/03/2025 to 21/03/2025 and physically inspected the baseline scenarios in line with VM0050 v1.0 and project technical design and implementation as specified in the VCS PD/5/ & MR /8/.

The site visit was conducted to verify the accuracy and completeness of the project implementation and to verify the accuracy of baseline reassessed. The views obtained during site observation were considered while concluding the verification opinion.

The sampling plan adopted by the VVB for carrying out the verification assessment is as follows.

The Sampling and surveys for CDM project activities and programmes of activities (Version 9.0)/17/ states under paragraph 28 that “When the project participants or the coordinating/managing entity have applied a sampling approach, the VVB may apply acceptance sampling as described in the steps indicated in paragraphs 29–38 below as part of validation/verification activities”.

Since the PP has monitored parameters ($n_{j,k,y}$, $\eta_{new,avg,y}$, and $BC_{p,j,k,y}$) through surveys, verification team conducted acceptance sampling in line with paragraph 30 and 31 of the sampling standard version 9.0/17/. $BC_{b,i,y}$ was also monitored for baseline reassessment with similar followed as for $BC_{p,j,k,y}$.

The verification team selected random sample of PP’s monitoring survey to check the acceptability (or otherwise) of the data for each such record with PP’s sample records and determined if the PP’s sample records meet the requirements. The sample size is calculated in conformance with paragraph 39 “A DOE may select a different sample size than the one indicated in paragraph 32 above, either by choosing a different value for the consumer risk and producer risk (e.g. 20 per cent for the consumer risk) when applying acceptance sampling or by using another approach, if any of the following conditions apply:

- (a) The estimated volume of annual GHG emission reductions of the project activity or the PoA being verified is equal to or less than 100,000 t CO₂ eq.;
- (b) The security conditions in the project region prevents inspection of many samples (e.g. conflict zones); or
- (c) The project activity or the PoA is located in a least developed country or a host Party with 10 or fewer registered CDM project activities at the end of the monitoring period being verified.

The grouped project is located in Rwanda, which is a Least Developed Country (LDC)/19/ Thus, the verification team can choose a different sample size than one indicated in para 32 of the sampling standard/17/.

The verification team selected random sample of PP’s monitoring survey records ($n_{j,k,y}$, $\eta_{new,avg,y}$, $BC_{b,i,y}$ and $BC_{p,j,k,y}$) to check the acceptability (or otherwise) of the data for each such record with PP’s sample records and determined if the PP’s sample records meet the requirements.

VVB team would like to mention here that during the course of verification process Project Review Report (PRR) comments were raised by Verra. In response to comment number-9 related to Monitoring and Sampling following assessment is provided by verification team.

1) Inclusion of Bifurcation by Vintage

- The MR (Section 4.3) includes snapshots of sample size calculations per monitoring parameter with vintage-specific sampling frames.
- The ER spreadsheet's "Sample Size Cal & Results" tab outlines the sample count per vintage. As per the dataset, the bifurcation is as follows:

Sampling Population	Sampling frame size	Calculated Min. Sample Size (n)	Monitored Sample Size ($n_{j,ktotal}$)
2022	132348	17	60
2023	202965	26	66

As per the above, the PP has monitored 60 and 66 samples respectively for the two vintages (strata), against the calculated sample sizes of 17 and 26. These 126 samples were randomly selected from the database, in line with the approach detailed in Section 4.3 of the MR, as follows:

- Nyabihu – 35 samples
- Huye – 30 samples
- Nyaruguru – 33 samples
- Rubavu – 28 samples

Verification of Sample Allocation:

- The ER sheet include the stratified random sampling aligned with CDM Sampling Guidelines v9.0 (para 15), applied to sub-populations (districts), ensuring representativeness of the entire population of 335,313 ICS distributed to date.
- Proportion of sampled ICS (124 HHs) from total distributed (335,313) = approx. 0.037%. This exceeds the statistically required minimum (95/10 confidence/precision achieved), which confirms adequacy for ex-post emission reduction calculation per VM0050 Section 9.3 and VCS Standard.

To align with Verra PRR finding number-9, section 2.3 of the VerR have been revised to include a table outlining the sampled distribution per district as listed above and a clarification that the stratified sampling method used ensures representativeness.

2) Justification for Selecting Nyabihu and Huye for Project Monitoring Sampling

Based on project implementation, field-level verification, and professional judgment, the selection of Nyabihu and Huye districts for project monitoring sampling (including 16 samples across project and baseline households) was conducted by the VVB in line with a risk-based and stratified sampling strategy, as required by CDM Sampling Standard v9.0 and VM0050 v1.0, Section 9.3. This selection was based on the following factors:

- Provincial Representation: Among the four districts covered by the project (Nyabihu, Rubavu, Huye, and Nyaruguru), Nyabihu and Rubavu lie in Western Province, and Huye and Nyaruguru are in Southern Province. The VVB deliberately selected one district from each province—Nyabihu (Western) and Huye (Southern)—to ensure regional representativeness and to reflect provincial diversity in household demographics and implementation contexts.
- Urban-Rural Socioeconomic Mix: Nyabihu and Nyaruguru are predominantly rural districts, while Huye and Rubavu include urban or peri-urban centers. However, analysis of the project database and survey results confirms that the distribution of Improved Cookstoves (ICS) is limited exclusively to rural areas. The audit team selected Nyabihu and Huye to capture rural

household dynamics, usage behavior, and stove performance, ensuring coverage of typical end-user segments. All four districts share a reliance on traditional biomass (wood fuel), confirmed through the baseline and project monitoring surveys.

- Climatic Homogeneity: All four districts are located in Rwanda's temperate highland climate zone, with similar altitudes and seasonal fuel use patterns. This climatic consistency supports the generalizability of sampled data across districts for fuel use behavior and technology performance.
- ICS Technology Uniformity: The project exclusively distributed Kuniokoa Generation 2 rocket stoves across all districts. Thus, technical consistency of the intervention minimized variability in usage data and allowed focus on geographic and behavioral representation.
- Logistical Considerations and Risk Mitigation: Selection of Nyabihu and Huye was also influenced by accessibility of records, safety of field operations, availability of CHWs, and established distribution infrastructure, critical for planning household visits in an LDC context like Rwanda.
- Professional Judgment and Field Expertise: The selection leveraged the VVB's local sectoral expertise and familiarity with Rwandan field conditions. This was validated through interviews with CHWs, DelAgua's field teams, and direct household verification during on-site visits, conducted from 18–21 March 2025.
- Representativeness of the Sample and District-wise Bifurcation: The audit team applied the acceptance sampling approach in accordance with CDM Sampling Standard v9.0 (Paragraphs 30–31, 39), adjusted for LDC conditions.
 - a) Project Monitoring Samples: 8 end-user households were selected for physical verification:
 - Huye District: 5 samples
(Stove barcodes: MQ040643, MQ047526, MQ014340, MQ119730, MQ198038)
 - Nyabihu District: 3 samples
(Stove barcodes: MQ295285, MQ279329, MQ331104)
 - b) Baseline Survey Samples: 8 households were selected for baseline validation in:
 - Ruhango District: 5 samples
 - Musanze District: 3 samples

These samples were found to be:

- Statistically acceptable (AQL 0.5%, UQL 20%, Producer Risk 5%, Consumer Risk 20%)
- Representative of the ~50,000 ICS distributed in the four project districts
- Reflective of usage patterns, installation accuracy, stove condition, and contractual compliance (carbon rights transfer agreements)

The selected households provided sufficient evidence to:

- Validate household-level records against the ICS distribution database (with geo-tagging)
- Assess stove usage, condition, and end-user satisfaction
- Confirm the absence of stove stacking or double participation in other programs

As stated above as part of the audit process, the VVB was required to travel to multiple locations to conduct field verification. In addition to the project household survey audit, baseline household audits were also conducted in two separate districts—Musanze and Ruhango—covering a total of 8 baseline samples. These visits already necessitated travel to four districts across Rwanda.

Given Rwanda's challenging topography and mountainous terrain, travel between districts—especially those located in different provinces—can be logistically demanding and time-consuming. Road travel in these regions often involves long distances over hilly, winding roads, limiting the number of districts that can be feasibly and safely covered within the audit timeframe. As such, the VVB selected Huye and Nyabihu districts for the project household survey audit. These locations were chosen for their geographic accessibility and their ability to provide representative coverage of the project area.

The Rubavu District, while part of the project area, was not selected due to ongoing security concerns related to its location on the border with the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC). During the audit period (18–21 March 2025), active conflict involving the M23 rebel group in eastern DRC led to increased instability in the surrounding region. Verified reports at the time indicated shelling and gunfire near Gisenyi (Rubavu border area), and the U.S. Embassy in Kigali issued a security alert warning of violence and travel disruptions along the border.

Moreover, the UK Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office (FCDO) continues to advise against all but essential travel to Rubavu District, citing the risk of conflict spillover from ongoing instability in eastern DRC. As per the FCDO's latest travel advisory ([source](#)): "There is a risk of conflict near the Rwanda-DRC border. The FCDO advises against all but essential travel to the Rubavu district, western Rwanda, due to the unpredictable security situation." This advisory is still active at the time of PRR submission, reinforcing the validity of the safety-related decision made during the audit period.

In summary, the selection of only two districts for the project survey audit was based on a careful assessment of logistical feasibility, geographical constraints, and credible real-time and ongoing security risks. The exclusion of Rubavu was a precautionary measure consistent with international safety guidance and reflects a responsible and justified audit planning approach.

Therefore, it is concluded by the VVB team to affirm that the project sampling design and field verification reflects a methodologically robust and conservatively designed plan and is fully compliant with VM0050 v1.0 (Section 9.3) and the CDM Sampling Standard v9.0. Also, it accounts for Rwanda's LDC status and field realities through application of local expertise, provincial representation, and risk-based sampling. This reassessed justification addresses Verra's concerns comprehensively and is appropriately reflected in this section of the FVR.

Sample Size:

AQL	UQL	Producer Risk	Consumer Risk	Sample Size; Min	Acceptance No.
0.5%	20%	5%	20%	8	0

The verification team covered a total of 8 project samples across to confirm monitoring survey results.

PAIs	Number of samples	District
1	3	Nyabihu
1	5	Huye

The verification team also covered a total of 8 baseline samples across to confirm monitoring survey results.

PAIs	Number of samples	District
1	5	Ruhango
1	3	Musanze

Baseline households confirmed usage of three stove stoves for cooking. All the project households interviewed were found to have the project operational. The verification team would like to conclude that based on acceptance sampling approach the project participant's sample record meets the requirement.

The list of interviewed users, project implementer and PP's representatives that were part of the site visit process is detailed in section 2.3 of the report.

2.5 Resolution of Findings

As discussed above, a risk-based approach has been applied for the verification of the project activity. During the verification, the assessment team identified the issues which could impact the accuracy and the credibility of the emission reduction claimed by the project. The detailed analysis of the issues raised the approach used to resolve these issues can be found in Appendix 4 of this report.

The Corrective Action Request (CAR) was raised if:

- Modifications to the implementation, operation, and monitoring of the registered project activity have not been sufficiently documented by the project participants.
- Mistakes have been made in applying assumptions, data, or calculations of emission reductions that will impact the number of emission reductions.
- The Clarification Request (CL) was raised if:
 - information is insufficient or not clear enough to determine whether the applicable requirements have been met.
- The Forward Action Request (FAR) was raised if:
 - if the monitoring and reporting require attention and/or adjustment for the next verification period.

During verification a total of 2 CARs, 14 CLs and 0 FARs were raised. The details of all the issues communicated to the PD can be found in the Appendix 4. The issues raised were closed successfully.

2.5.1 Forward Action Requests

The project activity is undergoing 2nd Verification, monitoring period from 01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024. There are 0 FARs that have been raised during the current verification period and also there is 1 FAR from previous verification period.

FAR from previous joint validation/verification report/6/:

FAR#1 is raised from joint validation-verification MP1 in relation to changes to Project Proponents involved in this project. PP shall clarify on how already existing households with end-user agreements with DelAgua Health Rwanda (Voluntary) Limited were informed about the change in PP of the grouped project activity to DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS).

CL # 2 was raised where PP's confirmed on DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) is the Project Proponent (PP) and holds the full ownership of the carbon rights for the project. PP confirmed the addition of a new PP does not affect the MoU. The new project proponent, DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS), is a wholly owned subsidiary within the DelAgua Group, similar to the original project proponent, DelAgua Health Rwanda Voluntary Limited. This project proponent is created to facilitate investment and sales, without affecting the operational delivery of the project. The evidence of change in form of Deed of Accession and Deed of Partial Release in Respect of VCS Listing Deed of Representation, both signed on the 28 Dec 2023 is submitted to VVB. From the project database information, the units credited has the last distributed date on the 27 July 2023 which is in prior to the timeline in which change of PP was initiated. All of the total 335,313 units of stoves credited with signed users agreements are valid referring to DelAgua Health Rwanda Voluntary Ltd which can be transferred as stated as part of the user agreement's declaration template. CL #2 was appropriately addressed and closed.

2.6 Eligibility for Validation Activities

There is no validation activity undertaken as a part of current verification.

3 VALIDATION FINDINGS

Change of methodology is performed from VMR0006 Methodology for Installation of High Efficiency Firewood Cookstoves v1.1 to VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0. In accordance with VCS Methodology Change Project Deviation Procedure v4.0, project description deviations is assessed by VVB under section 3.2 of the report.

3.1 Methodology Deviations

There is no methodology deviation identified during the current monitoring period.

3.2 Project Description Deviations

In line with the Procedure to change Methodology through a Project Description deviation V4.0, section 2.3, point 2.3.2, the assessment team has conducted the assessment of the project description document with methodology, VM0050 Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves V 1.0. A detailed assessment of the relevant sections can be found below.

Project Eligibility:

Exclusion under table 2.1 of VCS standard: The group project activity is distribution of improved cookstoves in Rwanda. The ICS distributed are energy efficient, reducing GHG emission. The project does not involve any activity that is explicitly excluded under Table 2.1 of the VCS Standard, such as grid-connected electricity generation, waste heat recovery, fossil fuel switching, or hydrofluorocarbon (HFC-23) emission reduction. Thus, the project is not excluded under Table 2.1 and meets the scope requirement of VCS standard v4.7.

The project meets the requirements of pipeline listing/27/: The pipeline listing date was 26/09/2022, preceding the start date of 04/11/2022, ensuring compliance with standardized additionality requirements. The project was formally registered on 27/11/2024 and is scheduled for further verification. These steps align with the VCS Standard v4.7 Section 3.8.1 and section 4.1.5, ensuring that the validation and registration processes are conducted within the prescribed timelines.

Methodology eligibility capacity limits: The project applies VM0050: Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, v1.0, an approved methodology under the Verra Standard. The methodology is applicable to the project activity, the applicability criteria of the methodology have been verified below. The methodology does not introduce any scale or capacity limits. Additionally, double counting prevention measures have been implemented through the assignment of a Unique Serial Number (USN) for each ICS, recorded in an electronic database/11/ in addition to this PP has submitted no double counting declaration/18/. This system ensures that emission reductions are not claimed multiple times. CL 06 was raised and closed after reviewing the sufficient evidence. The details related to the unique Number have been verified and assessed in detail and also the implementation of the process has been checked on site. Thus, the criteria have been met.

VVB team would like to mention here that during the course of verification process Project Review Report (PRR) comments were raised by Verra. In response to comment number-5 related to Double counting and Carbon project overlaps following assessment is provided by verification team.

Double counting of the project stoves:

Based on review of the objective evidence during the course of verification process, the VVB assessed the PP's safeguards and confirmations regarding stove traceability and carbon ownership. The following measures were verified:

1. Legal Agreement with Burn Manufacturing: The PP submitted a formal agreement with Burn Manufacturing, which includes a clearly worded clause:

"BURN agrees that it shall have no right, title, or claim to any carbon or impact credit earned or registered by DelAgua or any of its affiliates and associates pursuant to the use of the Products."

- This agreement ensures Burn has no carbon rights or overlapping claims for any ICS units sold to DelAgua.
- The document was submitted and reviewed as Document No. 18 in Appendix 2 of the Final Verification Report (FVR).

The contractual exclusion of carbon rights by Burn Manufacturing provides a clear legal safeguard preventing stove-level double counting from manufacturer-side programs.

2. Unique Identification and Traceability of ICS: Each stove distributed under the DelAgua project bears:

- A physical serial number permanently marked on the body,
- A DelAgua logo, and
- A barcode linked to an electronic database that includes stove ID, distribution date, user name, and location.
- The VVB cross-verified the physical identifiers during on-site household visits and reviewed the backend tracking system through sampled database entries.

The use of permanent, verifiable, and project-specific stove markings, coupled with digital traceability, ensures that each ICS is uniquely tagged to this project and cannot be reused or reassigned elsewhere, thereby eliminating the risk of stove-level double counting.

3. No Double Counting Declaration Letter: In compliance with VCS Standard v4.7, Section 3.23, the PP submitted a signed declaration letter confirming:

- No stove is part of any other GHG project or offset program,
- No stove is deregistered or excluded from another program,
- No carbon credits from this project are double claimed for compliance elsewhere,
- No other environmental attributes are claimed on these units.
- The declaration was submitted as part of Document No. 18 and reviewed during verification.

The declaration provides project-level assurance that no double counting of GHG reductions or stove units has occurred across any GHG mechanisms.

4. CL#06 during VVB Due Diligence: During the verification, the VVB raised Clarification Request #06 (CL#06) specifically addressing the risk of double counting due to stove procurement from Burn Manufacturing.

- In response, the PP submitted the Burn agreement, stove traceability protocol, and no double counting declaration.
- After comprehensive document review and cross-validation with site-level and system-level evidence, the VVB found the clarification satisfactorily resolved, and the CL was formally closed.

The VVB has actively identified, reviewed, and closed the double counting concern raised through CL#06 based on sufficient and verifiable documentation.

Therefore, it is concluded by the VVB team that the Project Proponent has implemented comprehensive and verifiable safeguards against double counting of ICS units and associated emission reductions. These include a contractual waiver of carbon rights by the manufacturer, stove-specific identification protocols, and a formal no double counting declaration aligned with VCS Standard v4.7, Section 3.23. All relevant documents were reviewed and validated, and the associated clarification was duly resolved during the verification process.

Stove overlaps, and the possibility of double claiming

2) Based on review of the objective evidence during the verification process, the VVB conducted a comprehensive assessment of the stove distribution process, focusing on the eligibility criteria, field protocols, and documentary safeguards implemented to avoid double claiming. The following multi-layered controls were verified:

1. Eligibility Screening Prior to Distribution

- The PP implements a strict eligibility protocol, as documented in the Carbon Operations Manual (Doc No. 46, Appendix 2, FVR).
- Only households using traditional cooking technologies (e.g., 3-stone fires or rudimentary wood stoves) as their primary baseline stove are considered eligible.
- Households with any type of improved stove (ICS from other carbon projects), fossil fuel-based technologies (LPG, kerosene, ethanol), or electric stoves are explicitly excluded from receiving a DelAgua ICS.
- During the household mobilization and pre-distribution screening, CHWs verify each household's baseline technology.

The VVB confirms that the PP has in place a field-level screening protocol to prevent overlaps with households that already use efficient or improved stoves, thereby addressing the risk of including households participating in other carbon projects.

2. Community-Level Orientation and Signed Informed Consent

- On distribution day, all eligible participants are gathered for a project introduction session. Here, the project's purpose, stove eligibility criteria, and carbon-related commitments are explained to beneficiaries.
- Each household signs the bottom of a DelAgua poster, confirming:

- Their use of traditional wood-based stoves prior to receiving the ICS,
- Their understanding of the stove's carbon credit association,
- Their consent to participate under the conditions of the DelAgua program.

The VVB reviewed samples of these signed poster agreements submitted by the PP as Document No. 14 in Appendix 2 of the FVR. The VVB concludes that the use of informed consent agreements, presented in a public setting with explanation of the project's carbon implications, adds a strong behavioral safeguard and formal acknowledgment by beneficiaries, supporting stove-use traceability and program exclusivity.

3. Operational Clause to Prevent Stove Overlaps: Each signed poster agreement includes a clause whereby the household agrees: "...not to purchase or accept any other improved stoves from any other entity after receiving the DelAgua ICS."

- This clause was specifically verified in the sample documents provided, and was confirmed during on-site interviews with beneficiaries and CHWs.
- The project team also confirmed that CHWs are trained to conduct follow-up checks and raise alerts if households acquire additional ICS from other interventions.

This explicit clause within the agreement acts as an operational safeguard, ensuring households make an affirmative commitment not to participate in overlapping projects. The VVB finds this an effective and auditable control to limit double claiming.

4. Record Keeping and Documentation: All signed household agreements are systematically collected, scanned, and archived. Further, these records are linked to the household's unique barcode ID in the stove distribution database. The VVB tea cross-checked these records during the audit, validating the consistency between signed declarations, household data, and stove assignments. Therefore, through proper documentation and system-level tracking of agreements, the project maintains audit-ready evidence of eligibility screening and distribution integrity.

Finally, the VVB confirms that the PP has established and implemented a comprehensive protocol for stove distribution that mitigates the risk of double claiming and stove overlaps within households. This includes:

- A clearly defined eligibility framework,
- Informed consent through signed declarations,
- A contractual clause preventing future stove acquisitions from other carbon projects,
- And proper recordkeeping with traceability through barcode-linked databases.

All submitted documents and field practices were reviewed and verified in accordance with VCS Standard v4.7, Section 3.23 and MR Template Section 1.11. The VVB is satisfied that the measures in place are robust and effective in maintaining the integrity of emission reductions claimed under this project.

Eligibility of the project activity in accordance with VCS Standard v4.7

S.No.	Applicability condition	Assessment and conclusion
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1	Projects shall meet all applicable rules and requirements set out under the VCS Program, including this document. Projects shall be guided by the principles set out in Section 2.2.1.	VVB has reviewed the project documents and confirms that the project complies to VCS standard v4.7 requirements guided by the ISO 14064-2:2006 . Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
2	Projects shall apply methodologies eligible under the VCS Program. Methodologies shall be applied in full, including the full application of any tools or modules referred to by a methodology, noting the exception set out in Section 3.14.1.	VVB has reviewed the project in accordance with VM0050 v 1.0, Correction and Clarifications To VM0050 Energy Efficiency And Fuel Switch Measures In Cookstoves, V1.0 and confirms that methodology is applied in full along with applicable tools and modules to ensure complete compliance. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
3	Projects shall apply the latest version of the applicable methodology in all cases unless a grace period applies to the project as set out in 3.22. Projects shall update to the latest version of the methodology when reassessing the baseline or renewing a crediting period.	VVB has reviewed the project documents in accordance with VM0050 v 1.0, Correction and Clarifications To VM0050 Energy Efficiency And Fuel Switch Measures In Cookstoves, V1.0 and confirms that grouped project applies the latest version 1.0 of VCS approved methodology. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
4	Projects and the implementation of project activities shall not lead to the violation of any applicable law, regardless of whether or not the law is enforced.	Project activity is completely in compliance with applicable laws of the host country. VVB has reviewed agreement between PP and GoR, project districts and found it satisfactory. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
5	Where projects apply methodologies that permit the project proponent its own choice of model, such model shall meet with the requirements set out in the VCS Program document VCS Methodology Requirements and it shall be demonstrated at validation that the model is appropriate to the project circumstances (i.e., use of the model will lead to an appropriate quantification of GHG emission reductions or removals).	Not applicable

6	Where projects apply methodologies that permit the project proponent to choose a third-party default factor or standard to ascertain GHG emission data and any supporting data for establishing baseline scenarios and demonstrating additionality, such default factor or standard shall meet with the requirements set out in the VCS Program document VCS Methodology Requirements.	Not applicable
7	Where the rules and requirements under an approved GHG program conflict with the rules and requirements of the VCS Program, the rules and requirements of the VCS Program shall take precedence.	Not applicable
8	Where projects apply methodologies from approved GHG programs, they shall conform with any specified capacity limits and any other relevant requirements set out with respect to the application of the methodology and/or tools referenced by the methodology under those programs.	The project activity is in accordance with VM0050 methodology which doesn't define any capacity limit.
9	Where Verra issues new VCS Program rules, the effective dates of these requirements are set out in Appendix 3 of VCS standard ver 4.7 and Effective Dates or equivalent for other program documents and are listed in a companion Summary of Effective Dates document which corresponds with each update.	VVB has reviewed the project documents and confirms that the project activity adheres to latest VCS program rules.

The applicability of the methodology VM0050 v1.0

S.No	Applicability condition	Assessment and conclusion
1	The project activity corresponds to: a) Replacement of non-renewable biomass (e.g., firewood, charcoal)-fired cookstoves with any of the following: i) More efficient project devices that use the same fuel as in the baseline; ii) Efficient project devices fired by renewable biomass or bioethanol; iii) Efficient project devices fired by liquefied petroleum gas (LPG); or iv) Electric-powered project devices. b) Replacement of solid or liquid fossil fuel (e.g., coal, kerosene)-fired cookstoves with any of the following:	The assessment team has crosschecked the registered PDMR, Previous verification report, WBT report/13/ of 13 samples conducted in current monitoring period, reassessed baseline survey submitted by PP. VVB confirms that project is using an efficient stove that uses same fuel i.e. firewood as baseline three stone stove. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met

	i) Efficient project devices fired by renewable biomass or bioethanol; ii) Efficient project devices fired by LPG; or iii) Electric-powered project devices.	
2	Project devices are used in households, communities, institutions, or small or medium enterprises (SMEs),⁴ collectively referred to in this methodology as the “target population.”	Assessment team has crosschecked registered PD, previous verification report, Project database and confirmed during onsite visit that households are the target population for the project activity. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
3	Where renewable biomass is used, it is exclusively renewable and qualifies as one of the following: a) A by-product, residue, or waste stream from agriculture, forestry, and related industries; or b) Originating from dedicated plantations that comply with all relevant applicability conditions in the most recent version of CDM TOOL16.	As per monitoring survey, baseline survey and interview conducted with households during onsite visit, firewood is the fuel used for cooking which is either collected from local area or purchased from local market/^{12/} Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
4	Where biomass residues are used, they would have been left to decay or burned without energy recovery before implementation of the project activity, and their use does not involve a decrease in carbon pools – in particular of dead wood, litter, or soil organic carbon – on the land areas from which the biomass residues originate.	As per monitoring survey, baseline survey interview conducted with households during onsite visit, firewood is the fuel used for cooking in the project scenario. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
5	Where biomass residues from a production process are used, project implementation does not result in an increase in the processing capacity of raw input or any other substantial changes (e.g., product change) in this process.	As per monitoring survey, baseline survey interview conducted with households during onsite visit, firewood is the fuel used for cooking in the project scenario. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met

6	Where more than one type of renewable biomass is used, each of the biomass types used complies with the applicability conditions	As per monitoring survey, baseline survey interview conducted with households during onsite visit, firewood is the fuel used for cooking in the project scenario. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
7	Where project activities introduce renewable biomass as charcoal, it is renewable charcoal produced by efficient charcoal production processes (e.g., retort sedentary kilns, improved sedentary kilns, Casamance kilns). Methane produced during the charcoaling process is captured and destroyed or combusted for energy purposes.	This condition is not applicable as firewood is the fuel used for cooking in the project scenario. This is confirmed by VVB by monitoring survey, baseline survey interview conducted with households during onsite visit
8	Project devices using renewable biomass (fuel-switch) or non-renewable biomass (improved efficiency) are single-pot, multi-pot portable, or in-situ cookstoves with an initial thermal efficiency of at least 25%.	The assessment team has crosschecked the registered PDMR, Previous verification report, WBT report/34/ of 13 samples conducted in current monitoring period, reassessed baseline survey/35/ submitted by PP. VVB confirms that the efficiency of project stove is more than 25%/34/.Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
9	Project devices using LPG or bioethanol are single-pot, multi-pot portable, or in-situ cookstoves with an initial thermal efficiency of at least 30%.	This condition is not applicable as firewood is the fuel used for cooking in the project scenario. This is confirmed by VVB by monitoring survey, baseline survey interview conducted with households during onsite visit
10	Electric project devices10 meet the maximum risk factor score of 15 on the Cookstove Durability Protocol11 and have the following minimum thermal efficiency: a) Hot plates and electric hobs: 40% b) Induction stoves and other electric stoves: 70%	This condition is not applicable as firewood is the fuel used for cooking in the project scenario. This is confirmed by VVB by monitoring survey, baseline survey interview conducted with households during onsite visit

11	Project devices using LPG comply with all of the following conditions: a) The baseline fuel either includes non-renewable biomass or is a more carbonintensive fossil fuel (demonstrated by the baseline survey, see Section 6.2); b) The project has a provision for metering LPG supplied to each consumer at the LPG filling station, in order to determine household LPG consumption; and c) The project does not seek to issue any carbon credits for periods after 31 December 2045.	This condition is not applicable as firewood is the fuel used for cooking in the project scenario. This is confirmed by VVB by monitoring survey, baseline survey interview conducted with households during onsite visit
12	Electric project devices use the following electricity sources: a) Decentralized renewable energy systems: Decentralized energy systems using fossil fuels are not eligible, except for backup generators that supply less than 1% of the annual electricity of the decentralized renewable energy system. b) Self-generated renewable electricity (with a maximum of 20% electricity from non-renewable sources for backup); c) National or regional electricity grid.	This condition is not applicable as firewood is the fuel used for cooking in the project scenario. This is confirmed by VVB by monitoring survey, baseline survey interview conducted with households during onsite visit
13	The project proponent designs incentive mechanisms to reduce the use of inefficient baseline devices and practices that can be replaced by the project devices and describes these mechanisms in the project description.	PP distributes ICS free of cost to household with financial barriers. In addition to this PP provides an awareness program to educate beneficiaries on proper use of stove. VVB verified the same during interview with households during site visit and cross checked the training records/29/ submitted by PP for current monitoring period. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met

14	Where a project device has ended its technical life, the project proponent either replaces it with a comparable or better project device or retrofits its essential components to continue meeting the minimum service level requirements (i.e., thermal energy generation), otherwise no further emission reductions may be claimed for the project device	As per the registered PD, previous verification reports the technical life of the project stove is 10 years. VVB has also verified 'Product Fact Sheet'/36/ from project stove manufacturer. The project was started in November 2022 and current MP is from 01 Jan 2023 to 31 Dec 2024 where the age of stove is 2 and 3 years based on the date of distribution which is well below the technical end life of the project stove. During the onsite visit interviews with project implementers, it was confirmed that PP would either go for project stove replacement with same or comparable project stove, or have its essential components retrofitted to continuously meet the minimum service level requirements (i.e., thermal energy generation). Otherwise, the project stove in question will not be accounted for project ER calculation. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
15	Project proponents implement a method for the distribution and identification of project devices that avoids double counting of emission reductions by other mitigation actions and includes unique product identification on the stove itself at the time of distribution/sale (e.g., program logo, alpha/numeric ID, and end-user location, such as geographic coordinates, complete address information)	PP has assigned unique barcode IDs to the project stoves which can be scanned to display end user information associated with that project stove. PP has maintained app-based system for data recording of end user credentials, stove ID, location, date of distribution. VVB has accessed this information during the onsite visit. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met

16	The project complies with any national, sub-national, or local regulations or guidance for the installation, commercialization, distribution, and use of improved cookstoves and/or fuel supply and use for the target population. National, regional, and local regulatory frameworks for the provision of the type of thermal energy services provided by the project activity must be documented.	VVB has crosschecked the MoU with government of Rwanda/28/. Project complies with national, sub-national, and local regulations and guidance for the installation, commercialization, distribution, and use of improved cookstoves and fuel supply for the target population. VVB has reviewed Biomass Energy Strategy (2019-2030) and updates to its Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) from government of Rwanda to encourage the adoption of efficient cookstoves. PP has submitted 'Project 3699 LoA' dated 27 October 2023/37/ that clearly states 10% of credits generated by this project will go directly to the GoR. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met
17	Where project activities reduce emissions from non-renewable biomass, including firewood and charcoal, the risk of double counting is assessed on a national basis by evaluating at validation and crediting period renewal whether there are REDD+ projects or jurisdictional REDD+ programs whose project boundary overlaps with the expected fuel source area of the project. The project proponent must report on the findings of this assessment for informational purposes in the project description	CL #6 was raised. PP has submitted a declaration on no double accounting or double claiming. CL #6 is satisfactorily closed by VVB. Moreover, assessment team has evaluated the risk of double accounting as REDD+ projects/programs across various registries namely Gold standard, GCC, CAR, Verra, CDM. VVB has crosschecked the period verification reports for the same. There are no REDD+ project in the host country. Therefore, the criteria is found to be met

Therefore, it has been concluded that the project activity is eligible under the VCS program.

Project start date and crediting period:

The assessment team has start date from registered PD, previous verification reports and also verified with PP during the onsite visit for the project, the start date mentioned for the project activity is inline with VCS standard V4.7, section 3.8. The crediting period for the project is 04/11/2022 to 03/11/2029 Thus, the start date and crediting period of the project is accepted.

Project scale and estimate emission reductions:

The group project is calculating emission reductions based on VM0050: Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, v1.0, and is categorizing the project as large scale inline with VCS standard, section 3.10, "Large projects: Greater than 300,000 tonnes of CO₂e per year".

Based on the assumption values taken by the project to calculate the estimated emission reduction it can be concluded that the project is inline with the methodology and will be able to achieve the emission reductions mentioned.

Conditions prior to project initiation

The conditions prior to the project initiation are same as described in the baseline scenario for the project, continued use of non-renewable wood fuel using unimproved open fire three stone firewood and the already validated statement remain valid during the methodology change as well. More details related to the crosscheck of baseline scenario can be found in section 2.3 of the report.

Title and reference of methodology

During the current Monitoring the project undergoing a methodology change from VMR0006 Methodology for installation of High Efficiency Firewood Cookstoves v1.1 to VM0050 Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, 1.0 inline with the guidelines release by VERRA on 9/10/2024 (<https://verra.org/verra-releases-new-cookstoves-methodology/>).

Along with the methodology project applies the latest version of tool 30 Calculation of the fraction of non-renewable biomass V4.0 and CDM Guideline: Sampling and surveys for CDM project activities and programmes of activities, v4.0 and CDM sampling standard, V9.0, all the applicable tools and methodology applies the latest version therefore acceptable.

Project boundary

Project determines the boundary inline, VM0050 Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, V1.0, In line with methodology section 5, project boundary includes the project devices, the geographical site where they are located, and the locations from which baseline and project fuels are sourced.

The assessment team was able to ensure that the approved methodology addresses all the identified emission sources that are impacted by the project activity as mentioned in section 3.3 of revised PD.

Additionality

Regulatory surplus Requirements:

Rwanda is non-Annex 1 country and host country doesn't mandate implementation of the project activity by any law, statute or other regulatory framework. VVB has reviewed NDC LoA submitted by PP in response to CL #6. As per the document project will be obligated to make available 10 % of total carbon credit for ITMO authorization to government of Rwanda. This is inline with host country national framework for carbon market in Rwanda to fulfill requirements under article 6 of the Paris agreement.

In accordance with the positive list requirements:

1)The project activity introduces:

- a)Efficient biomass-fired cookstoves that replace inefficient biomass-fired cookstoves;
- b)Efficient, solely renewable biomass-fired cookstoves that replace fossil fuel-fired cookstoves; or
- c)Electric cookstoves that replace inefficient biomass-fired or fossil fuel-fired cookstoves.

2) The project activity installs or distributes improved cookstoves at zero cost to the end user and has no revenue source other than from the sale of verified carbon units (VCUs).

During the onsite visit by assessment time interviews were held with project households and it was confirmed that households are provided with project stoves free of cost.

The verification team would like to highlight that during the course of the verification process, Verra raised comments through the Project Review Report (PRR). In reference to Comment #7 concerning the information and assessment of applicability conditions and eligibility criteria for free-of-cost distribution of ICS, the following assessment is provided by the verification team based on a review of project documentation, field team interviews, and evidence gathered during the site visit.

Assessment of applicability conditions and eligibility criteria for free-of-cost distribution of ICS

1. Review of MoU/43/ (Refer appendix-2 of FVR with document No. 43): The VVB reviewed the MoU submitted by the PP, which is duly signed by representatives of:

- The Ministry of Environment,
- The Ministry of Finance and Economic Planning, and
- DelAgua Health Rwanda Implementation Ltd (DHRI) and DelAgua Health Rwanda

Implementation (Korea) Ltd (DHRI(K)).

The MoU clearly stipulates that the improved cookstoves will be distributed at no cost to households, establishing a formal commitment under the Government-supported project framework.

2. Field Verification–Household Interviews: During the on-site audit conducted from 18–21 March 2025, the verification team visited eight households across Huye and Nyabihu districts (see Tables 1–2 in the FVR). Each interviewed beneficiary independently confirmed the following:

- They received the improved cookstove without payment or charges.
- They did not provide money or services in exchange for the stove.
- Distribution was coordinated through Community Health Workers (CHWs), with no expectation of compensation.

3. Field Verification–Staff Interviews: The VVB also interviewed six field-level implementers, including CHWs and data analysts (Table-3 in the FVR), who confirmed that:

- Households were not charged at any stage of the distribution process.
- The no-cost distribution approach is aligned with internal training and implementation guidelines.
- No transaction records (receipts, invoices, etc.) are generated because no payments are involved.

4. Documentation and System Review:

The distribution database and user agreement templates were reviewed. These do not include any pricing, sales, or financial fields that would suggest a commercial transaction occurred. The absence of financial data fields is consistent with a zero-cost distribution model.

Therefore, it is concluded by the VVB verification team that the Project Proponent has fully demonstrated, through documentary evidence and field-level validation, that the improved cookstoves (ICS) were distributed free of cost to all beneficiary households during the monitoring period (01 January 2023 to 31 December 2024). This conclusion is based on the formal commitment outlined in the signed Memorandum of Understanding with the Government of Rwanda, corroborated by consistent confirmations from end users and field staff during on-site verification, and the absence of any financial transactions or related documentation in the project's distribution records. The verification team confirms that the project is in full compliance with the requirements of VM0050 v1.0.

VVB has crosschecked baseline, monitoring surveys and KPTs with onsite interviews with households and can confirm firewood is used as fuel to cook on ICS and baseline stoves. Moreover, VVB has reviewed and accepted WBT, fact sheet documents submitted by PP which mention about the efficiency of the stove more than the baseline ones.

Hence the project activity is deemed additional.

The appropriateness of the baseline scenario

In accordance with the requirement of VM0050, Correction And Clarifications To VM0050 Energy Efficiency And Fuel Switch Measures In Cookstoves, V1.0 baseline was reassessed.

In accordance with clarification 1 of Correction And Clarifications To VM0050 Energy Efficiency And Fuel Switch Measures In Cookstoves, V1.0, VVB has reviewed host country survey on cooking/38/ along with baseline KPTs/35/ performed in the current monitoring period. It can be concluded that KPT performed to reassess wood consumption in the baseline scenario to be 4.04 tons/HH/year which conservative with respect to national cooking survey report for Rwanda i.e. 6.57 tons/HH/year. CL #8 was raised and satisfactorily closed.

VVB has reviewed the project documents, registered PD, pervious verification report and confirms project boundaries are unchanged. In addition to this, the project adheres to the monitoring plan in line with VM0050 v1.0

Quantification of GHG emission reductions and carbon dioxide removals

The project activity is quantifying the emission reductions based on methodology VM0050: Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, v1.0, the assessment team has assessed the details it has been observed that it conservatively estimated. Further details related to the calculation can be found in section 4.4 of this report.

Leakage assessment: The PD has assessed the additionality on the basis of methodology VM0050: Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, v1.0, In line with section 8.3, based on the based with association with reduced or avoiding the use of non-renewable biomass, the leakage gas been correctly applied as 0.95. There it is acceptable.

Methodology deviations

Methodology deviations are described in section 3.1 of the report. There is no methodology deviation applied in the project.

Monitoring plan

The assessment team reviewed the monitoring plan described in the Project Design Document and confirms that it clearly identifies all relevant parameters to be monitored as per the applied methodology VM0050: Energy Efficiency and Fuel-Switch Measures in Cookstoves, Version 1.0.

Key monitored parameters include (more details related the parameter can be found in section 4.3 and 4.4 of the project report):

- Number of stoves distributed and operational
- Thermal efficiency of project devices
- Fraction of non-renewable biomass (fNRB)

- Usage rate of the improved cookstoves
- Baseline and project scenario fuel consumption Leakage emissions (via applied adjustment factor)

It has been verified by the assessment team that monitoring procedures outlined in the PDD ensure traceability, consistency, and conservativeness based on the onsite visit and the evidence submitted. The project utilizes a digital data management system for stove registration, tracking each stove by a Unique Serial Number (USN)/11/. The procedures for data collection, entry, validation, and storage are robust and compliant with the methodology requirements.

Monitoring equipment and methods, including household surveys, field verification, and sampling protocols, are designed in accordance with the methodological guidance. Internal quality assurance protocols and field team training further enhance data credibility.

Based on document review and site audit findings, the assessment team concludes that the monitoring plan has been effectively implemented and is fully in adherence with the requirements of the applied methodology and the referenced tools. No deviations were noted, and the system is capable of ensuring accurate and consistent monitoring throughout the crediting period.

Hence, project deviation is valid.

3.3 New Project Activity Instances in Grouped Projects

From the start of crediting period, only 1 PAI is included in the Grouped Project. New units of project stove distributed in the MP2 as many as 202,965 units are distributed in PAI1 which is the only PAI since MP1.

With new distributed units disseminated in existing PAI the assessment of eligibility of the new units are as followed as per set criteria in the Project Description/5/ :

Eligibility criteria following section 3.6.10 to 3.6.15 of the VCS Standard v 4.7/1/:

S.No	Eligibility criteria description in the PD	Means of proof (Information/document) required as listed in the Project Description	Assessment by the verification team
1.	Grouped projects shall specify one or more clearly defined geographic areas within which project activity instances may be	Each PAI will have clearly defined geographic areas and such area will be specified using geodetic polygons.	The project has been implemented within the geographical boundary of Rwanda which has been verified from the KML

	developed. Such geographic areas shall be specified using geodetic polygons		files/15/ provided by the PP which was found to be correct. This has been verified for the new units distributed units from information on the location derived from the project distribution database/11/ and data from monitoring survey/12/, Furthermore, it has been confirmed during the on-site visit/10/ that the project was implemented in Rwanda.
2	Determination of baseline scenario and demonstration of additionality are based upon the initial project activity instances. The initial project activity instances are those that are included in the project description at validation and shall include all project activity instances currently implemented on the issue date of the project description.	Baseline scenario and demonstration of additionality shall be based upon the initial project activity instances	Baseline scenario is reassessed to confirm continued use of non-renewable wood fuel by the target population to meet similar thermal energy needs as provided by project cookstoves in absence of project activity. Details captured from newly added stove distributed in MP2 confirmed that the same baseline scenario reflected in the information captured by the signed user agreement as well as verification on the information for baseline stoves during site visit/10/. The project is not mandated by Rwandan laws and the project is deemed additional as the project meet all the applicability conditions of the methodology and comply with the positive list. Under the additionality section of the applied

			methodology /7/, it is stated that where the project activity installs or distributes stoves at zero cost to the end-user and has no other source of revenue other than the sale of GHG credits, the project activity shall be deemed additional which was confirmed from the end user agreement/14/ which confirmed that the ICS were distributed at zero cost. The additionality assessment is verified during site visit/10/ for confirmation from household user's whether the technology stoves are received free of charge.
3	Where a grouped project includes multiple project activities, the project description shall designate which project activities may occur in each geographic area.	The grouped project includes only one project activity.	No new PAI added in this MP. The only PAI in the GP is confirmed to have 1 project activity, the same from MP1.
4	The baseline scenario for a project activity shall be determined for each designated geographic area, in accordance with the methodology applied to the project.	Baseline scenario for a project activity shall be determined for each designated geographic area, in accordance with the methodology applied to the project	The baseline scenario is reassessed and confirmed to be the same with no sighted change, Baseline scenario details in PD/5/ is continued use of non-renewable wood fuel or fossil fuel by the target population to meet similar thermal energy needs as provided by project cookstoves in absence of project activity. Details captured from newly added users showed that the same baseline

			scenario reflected in the information captured by the signed user agreement as well as verification on the information for baseline stoves during site visit/10/. The project is verified not mandated by Rwandan laws and the project is deemed additional as the project meet all the applicability conditions of the methodology and comply with the positive list. Under the additionality section of the applied methodology /5/, it is stated that where the project activity installs or distributes stoves at zero cost to the end-user and has no other source of revenue other than the sale of GHG credits, the project activity shall be deemed additional which was confirmed from the end user agreement/14/ which confirmed that the ICS were distributed at zero cost. The additionality assessment is verified during site visit/10/ for confirmation from household user's whether the technology stoves are received free of charge.
5	The additionality of the initial project activity instances shall be demonstrated for each designated geographic area, in accordance	Additionality for a project activity instance shall be determined for each designated geographic area, in accordance with the methodology applied to the project	The project is not mandated by Rwandan laws and the project is deemed additional as the project meet all the applicability conditions of the methodology and also

			comply with the positive list. Under the additionality section of the applied methodology /5/, it is stated that where the project activity installs or distributes stoves at zero cost to the end-user and has no other source of revenue other than the sale of GHG credits, the project activity shall be deemed additional which was confirmed from the end user agreement/14/ which confirmed that the ICS were distributed at zero cost. The additionality assessment is verified during site visit/10/ for confirmation from household user's whether the technology stoves are received free of charge.
6	Where factors relevant to the determination of the baseline scenario or demonstration of additionality requires assessment across a given area, the area shall be, at a minimum, the grouped project geographic area. Examples of such factors include, inter alia, common practice; laws, statutes, regulatory frameworks, or policies relevant to demonstration of regulatory surplus; determination of regional grid emission factors; and historical deforestation and degradation rates	All the factors relevant to the determination of baseline or demonstration of additionality shall be done for the geographical boundary of the grouped project	New units distributed under PAI1 are confirmed to have the same baseline scenario and are automatic additional (through activity method by distributing ICS free of cost, similar to initial PAIs) as per methodology/7/ requirement. The new units distributed are verified located in the same region as the existing PAI1 as verified through analysis on the location of the distribution database/11/ as well as site visit/10/. Verifier team has verified that there are no laws or

			regulations in Rwanda that restrict the use of improved cookstoves (ICS) in households/30/. The project is a voluntary effort by the project proponent which is in line with National Strategy for Transformation (NST1) 2017–2024/32//33/.
7	The new PAI must comply with at least one complete set of eligibility criteria for the inclusion of new project activity instances. Partial compliance with multiple sets of eligibility criteria is insufficient.	The eligibility criteria set must be complied by the PAIs at all points in time throughout the crediting period. If at any point, it is found that the PAI is not complying with the set of eligibility criteria, then it may be excluded from the crediting for the duration of the monitoring period, until it is able to demonstrate the compliance of the eligibility criteria.	Assessment on new units distributed in MP2's eligibility criteria is concluded meeting all the relevant criteria.
8	The new PAI must be included in the monitoring report with sufficient technical, financial, geographic and other relevant information to demonstrate compliance with the applicable set of eligibility criteria and enable sampling by the validation/verification body.	The new PAI will include all the technical, financial, geographic and other relevant information related to the compliance of the applicable set of eligibility criteria & also enable sampling by the VVB.	The new project units distributed in MP2 (under PAI1) is verified to be the same with details in Project Description/9/ which is Kuniokoa Generation 2 stove, which is verified to the same technology model from first monitoring period. In the monitoring report, same stove technology model is verified as sighted in section 1.1 of the Monitoring Report. Site visit/10/ includes visual observation on the model stove that is distributed. Verification includes cross check against monitoring report for PD/5/ as well as

			Rocket Works website for project specification/25/.
9	The new PAI must be validated at the time of verification against the applicable set of eligibility criteria.	The new PAI(s) shall be part of the monitoring, and therefore, will be validated against the criteria specified, by a VCS accredited/approved VVB.	NA, no new PAI included in this MP.
10	The new PAI must have evidence of project ownership, in respect of each project activity instance, held by the project proponent from the respective start date of each project activity instance (i.e., the date upon which the project activity instance began reducing or removing GHG emissions).	The PAI related evidence on the project ownership will be in the form of a distribution end user receipt poster. This will be signed by the end user, and a photograph of him/her holding the poster along with the ICS will be saved in the PAI database.	Signed users' agreements/14/ were verified as part of the verification process for the new units with sighted statement (see CL#2) includes acknowledgement that the project stove is distributed free of cost and DelAgua Health Rwanda (Voluntary) will claim the CO2 emissions reductions from the stove. The same is verified verbally with project stover users during site visit/10/. Information of date of stove distribution date for each user is recorded and verified in project database/13/ and traced back to project internal database system. Revision in the project proponent of VCS 3699 is sighted with process of revision of such is verified from the document made available in Verra Registry with uploads dated 28/12/2023. The last ICS units distributed under MP2 27/07/2023 which is verified by VVB, no new units have been distributed.

			From the verification processes above, for MP2 up to 28/12/2023 the project ownership is under DelAgua Health Rwanda (Voluntary Limited) which is transferred to DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (Registry User) with the signed Deed of Deed of Accession by 28/12/2023. The rights over VCUs calculated and claimed through monitoring report MP2 (01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024) is concluded to have been demonstrated with ownership of DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. See CL#2 for details
11	The new PAI must have a start date that is the same as or later than the grouped project start date.	The new PAI will have a start date later than the GP start date.	The start date of the Grouped Project is at 04/11/2022 as reflected in the JPD MR/5/ and Joint Validation and Verification Report/6/ which is the start of distribution date for PAI-1. From the distribution database provided/11/, the distribution date of the newly added units under PAI1 is verified to be after the start date of GP. The information is verified through verbal confirmation with technology recipients.
12	The new PAI must be eligible for crediting from the start date of the instance through to the end of the project crediting period (only).	The PAI will be only eligible for the crediting from its start date through to the end of the project crediting period (only).	No new PAI is added into the GP in this MP2. All the distributed units are under PAI1 only.

	The new PAI shall not be or have been enrolled in another VCS project .	It will be ensured that the PAI that is being enrolled under the VCS GP was not previously enrolled under any other VCS project, and will not be enrolled under other VCS project if it is removed from the VCS GP.	No new PAI is added into the GP in this MP2.
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Overall, verification team confirms that new project technology units distributed in MP2 under the same PAI from MP1 comply with the eligibility criteria of VCS Standard v 4.7.

3.4 Baseline Reassessment

Did the project undergo baseline reassessment during the monitoring period?

☒ Yes ☐ No

The verification team would like to highlight that during the course of the verification process, Verra raised comments through the Project Review Report (PRR). In reference to Comment #8 concerning the Baseline reassessment and KPT, the following assessment is provided by the verification team based on a review of project documentation, field team interviews, and evidence gathered during the site visit.

Assessment for Baseline reassessment and KPT:

1) Assessment of Sample Design and Representativeness: The VVB confirms that the sampling strategy employed by the Project Proponent (PP) aligns with the requirements of:

- CDM Standard: “*Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and PoAs*” Version 9.0Meth_Stan05,
- Appendix 5 of VM0050, v1.0VM0050-v1.0,
- and Section 6.2 of VM0050, which mandates stratified or simple random sampling over homogenous or heterogenous target populationsVM0050-v1.0.

The PP employed stratified random sampling across Rwanda’s four rural provinces (Eastern, Western, Northern, Southern), explicitly excluding Kigali due to its urban profile. Stratification by province addresses regional heterogeneity in geography, infrastructure, and socio-economic contexts. Within each province, 3 districts were selected (12 of 27 in total), ensuring geographic spread and coverage. The number of districts sampled aligns with logistical feasibility and ensures minimum statistical thresholds for representativeness and 90/10 confidence/precision were maintained.

2) Randomness and Household Selection Procedure: The VVB validated that:

- Villages within each district were selected by trained field staff using logistical criteria (accessibility, safety) and representativeness filters (cultural and socio-economic

- comparability).
- Households within villages were selected using a random walk method, every fifth household encountered was assessed for eligibility, which is a recognized and accepted field sampling technique under CDM guidance.

This method was corroborated during site visits and interviews with Community Health Workers (CHWs) and DelAgua staff who were involved in the baseline survey execution.

3) Statistical Adequacy and Oversampling

The minimum sample size requirement (55 HHs) for parameter BCb,i,y was calculated using CDM guidelines. The PP oversampled to 128 HHs (more than double), ensuring robustness against non-responses, data quality issues, and improving statistical confidence.

Province	Min Required	Covered
Eastern	17	33
Northern	10	33
Southern	14	33
Western	14	29
Total	55	128

This sample size exceeded the requirement for 90/10 confidence/precision, which was validated by the VVB during verification through recalculation and cross-reference to ER spreadsheets and the “Sample Size Cal & Results” tab.

4. Assessment of Representativeness Based on Cooking Practices: The VVB acknowledges that:

- National literature and the Rwanda Population and Housing Census (2022) confirm uniformity in cooking practices across rural regions, with beans, banana, and root vegetable stews being predominant.
- This homogeneity in baseline behavior supports the assumption that selected households are representative of the broader rural population.

5. Site Visit Confirmation

During the field audit conducted from 18–21 March 2025, the VVB visited 8 households and interviewed both project and baseline stove users across Huye and Nyabihu districts. It was confirmed:

- Households were randomly chosen.
- Field teams followed the protocol in selecting districts, villages, and respondents.
- No indication of sampling bias or preferential selection was found

Therefore, it is concluded by VVB team that the baseline survey was designed and implemented in alignment with CDM and VM0050 requirements. The use of stratified random sampling, adequate geographic coverage, oversampling, and validation through site visits and national data ensures the results are statistically robust and representative of Rwanda’s rural population.

Baseline survey and controlled households

1. Review of Supporting Documents: The VVB confirms that the PP submitted the complete set of

baseline KPT datasheets, raw survey records, and analysis sheets as required under VM0050 Appendix 5 and the CDM Sampling and Survey Standard v9.0. These documents were received and reviewed under CL#8, with final datasets provided in Appendix 2 of the Final Verification Report (FVR) under Document Nos. 35 and 40.

2. Methodological Conformance:

- As this was the first monitoring period following transition to VM0050 v1.0, the establishment of control households prior to verification is a mandatory requirement per VM0050, Appendix 5 and Clarification #9.
- The project correctly selected 128 control households using a stratified random sampling technique compliant with CDM Sampling Guidelines.

3. Representativeness and Consistency with National Data:

- The control group comprised:
 - 124 households (96.8%) using wood as primary fuel
 - 4 households (3.2%) using both wood (primary) and charcoal (secondary)
- These results are consistent with Rwanda's 2022 National Census data, affirming 94% of rural households use firewood, and 4% charcoal.

The 128 households selected for the baseline surveys / KPT have been earmarked as the controlled households for follow-up surveys by PP. These household possesses the same characteristics and requires for controlled households as per applied meth. Further, the project activity yet to achieve 5 years to do baseline reassessment as per applied meth. PP cannot withhold right to access clean energy to controlled household, any of the user shifted to clean energy will be replaced with new controlled household with similar characteristics and PP to update its baseline to reflect these changing background conditions as applicable. Thus, accepted by VVB.

4. Verification via Site Visits and Interviews:

- The VVB conducted on-site audits at a subset of control households in Ruhango and Musanze districts between 19–20 March 2025.
- Physical observations, stove inspections, interviews with baseline stove users, and confirmation of recorded data entries were carried out to validate fuel use patterns, household size, and stove types.

5. Quality Assurance and Transparency:

- The baseline KPTs were executed following KPT v3.0 protocols with trained enumerators and achieved the required 95/10 confidence/precision level. The calculated average baseline consumption was:
 - 0.937 tons/person/year
 - 4.04 tons/household/year (based on 4.31 average household size), confirming conservative estimates.

6. VVB Judgment on Sufficiency and Compliance:

- The documentation provided was complete, consistent, and validated via both desk review and field verification.
- The identification of control households was robust, and the baseline fuel use data is

aligned with both national trends and methodology expectations.

Therefore, it is concluded by the verification team that the Project Proponent has fully complied with the requirements of VM0050 v1.0 and the CDM Sampling and Survey Standard v9.0 in conducting the baseline survey and Kitchen Performance Tests (KPTs) among the identified control households. This conclusion is based on an in-depth review of the submitted KPT and survey datasets, on-site field verification and interviews with selected baseline households, confirmation of the statistical representativeness of the sample, and alignment with methodological guidance under Appendix 5 of VM0050 and Clarification #9. All necessary documentation was made available, reviewed, and validated by the verification team.

In accordance with clarification 1 of Correction And Clarifications To VM0050 Energy Efficiency And Fuel Switch Measures In Cookstoves, V1.0, VVB reviewed host country survey on cooking/38/ along with baseline KPTs/35/ performed in the current monitoring period submitted by PP. It can be concluded that KPT performed to reassess wood consumption in the baseline scenario to be 4.04 tons/HH/year which conservative with respect to national cooking survey report for Rwanda i.e. 6.57 tons/HH/year. CL #8 was raised and satisfactorily closed.

PP has reevaluated fNRB value in accordance with VM0050 v 1.0. In response to CL #14, PP used registered value that was calculated in accordance with CDM Tool 30, version 4.0 and applied uncertainty discount of 26% as discussed in methodology section 9.2. VVB confirms data is considered for fNRB calculation is still the latest available.

During Onsite visit VVB visited 8 baseline households and confirmed the use of firewood for cooking in the baseline based on interviews conducted. Please refer to section 2.3 For details.

4 VERIFICATION FINDINGS

4.1 Project Details

The project “DelAgua Improved Cookstove Grouped Project” (VCS ID 3699) Grouped Project (“GP”) by be DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) falls into sectoral scope 03 and is appropriately selected in the VCS PD & MR and is implemented in Rwanda. The project category and type are correctly indicated in the VCS PD/5/ & MR/08/. It has been indicated as well as accepted that it is a grouped project activity.

The project entity DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) which is revised from the original PP (see CL#2). No other project proponent or project partners are identified involved in the project implementation. This is verified against previous verification report as well as confirmation from the field team during interviews in the site visit/10/.

The start date of the Grouped project activity is 04/11/2022 which is verified from the joint validation & verification report/6/ as the joint PD & MR/5/. From the start of crediting period, only 1 PAI is included in the Group Project which is verified from the verification against distribution database/11/. New units of project stoves distributed in MP2 under the same PAI as in the MP1. Monitoring period 2 claimed encompasses period of 01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024 with verified ER claimed of 1,911,382 tCO₂e with new distributed units of 202,965 units and total of 335,313 units distributed from the start of the crediting period.

The project crediting period is correctly filled in VCS PD/5/, which is seven years (twice renewables). The selected crediting period is consistent with the project start date and the first crediting period spans from 04/11/2022 to 03/11/2029 (both days included).

The project is correctly classified as large project as per VCS Standard /1/ as the average annual emission reductions are more than 300,000 tCO₂e. The estimated emission reductions are consistent with the corresponding ER spreadsheet /9/.

Project design, including eligibility criteria for grouped projects:

The project activity involves distribution of improved cookstoves in households of Rwanda. The project is a voluntary initiative as host country laws do not mandate the distribution of ICS to the local communities/30/. The project proponent is verified to be DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) who is using carbon finance to support local partners engaged in different activities like production, distribution, and maintenance of various product technologies. Revision of project proponent from the original PP as verified from Verra Registry to current PP DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) was raised and resolved in detail in CL#2. This project includes technologies designed to reduce GHG emission by supplying high efficiency ICS to end-users and promoting public health to tackle several health challenges caused due to using less efficient stoves. The description of the ICS models is given in PD/5/ & MR/8/ and was confirmed from manufacturer's specification (verified from previous monitoring period and verification report/5/6/).

The grouped project activity envisages distribution of one models of ICS i.e. Kuniokoa Generation 2 which is verified during the site visit/10/ and as well as the verified purchase order/39/

Eligibility assessment on the newly distributed unit of stoves in the monitoring period can be found in section 3.3 of the verification report.

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion:
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Audit history	The project activity is undergoing 2 nd Verification under its first crediting period. The assessment team has verified that audit history using the Project webpage/4/, all the previous verification has been published under Verra. It has been concluded that the information present in section 1.2 of MR is appropriate.
Double counting and participation under other GHG programs	The project activity is not registered under any other GHG and non-GHG program or registry. This has been confirmed by means of research on relevant applicable registries and available information in public domain and through declaration from the Project Owner. The assessment team has searched for similar projects with the same nature, project technology, location and project proponent as well as legal owner. The name of the owners mentioned in the regulatory licenses are also matched and checked. Under CDM registry, it is found that Project Proponent (DelAgua Health Rwanda Limited) has one PoA '00009626: DelAgua Public Health Program in Eastern Africa' with crediting period 21 Nov 2013 - 20 Nov 2020 in Rwanda. The monitoring reports were verified for the entirety of the crediting period with different stove model. With this finding, VCS3699 does not claim ER credit for the same activity and same user in the same period, thus it was concluded that no evidence that the project is double claiming the same ER in various carbon schemes like CDM, GCC, and Gold Standard.
No double claiming with emissions trading programs or binding emission limits	The project activity has been thoroughly search on the various websites of various emission trading programs and or ETS programs running in various counties, using nature, project technology, location and project proponent as well as legal owner as the search option
No double claiming with other forms of environmental credit	As discussed above the, the project has been thoroughly search in the currently active environment schemes and found that the project is not registered with any other environmental credits. PP has also submitted a declaration stating that the project is not registered with any other registry (see CL#6). Therefore, it can be concluded that the project is not claiming any credits from other programs/schemes.
Supply chain (scope 3) emissions double claiming	The grouped project activity which aims at distribution of ICS to households does not result in any Scope 3 emissions in its supply chain.
Sustainable development contributions	As claimed in section 1.12 of the monitoring report, the project is claiming positive impact for the following:

-SDG 1.4.1 impact for the total number of ICS distributed under the grouped project is 335,313 hence, 335,313 HHs receiving the project ICS now have access to basic cooking services. This is verified through project database as well as through site visit/10/ for the accuracy and completeness of the distribution database.

-SDG 3.9.1 impact calculated at Project instances level and calculated for number of households that are affected with project implementation which is verified to be 332,652 households (99.21% of surveyed household positively claimed less smoke out of 335,313 units distributed) receiving the project ICS now claiming positive perceived impact in terms of smoke level from the project implementation. Claim is verified against survey monitoring data and verified through site visit/10/.

-SDG 4.7.1 impact is claimed through 2 indicators:

a) The number of Community Health Workers that were educated (trained for distribution, 6-monthly household visits, surveys, and training on sustainable cooking practices to be disseminated to end user households) which is verified from the total employed personals for project implementation. SDG 4.7.1 impact claim which is verified satisfactorily with 3,239 trained CHWs.

b) The number of end users per household that are educated for stove usage and apply sustainable cooking practices are equal to the exact number of households where project ICS are distributed. PP implemented distribution of project stove together with training material and distributed posters in public event which is verified through sampled signed user agreements, sampled household visit and project distribution list database. With total 335,313 units distributed from start of crediting period, project impact is verified to be 335,313 households that had received education on clean cooking under this indicator.

-SDG 5.4.1 impact is claimed through the calculated % respondents from monitoring survey with perceived positive impact on the amount of time tending fire and collecting wood. 96,83% of the survey participants that claimed the positive impact is used to calculated as 324.668 households out of the total distributed 335,313 units. The data is verified using acceptance sampling approach during site visit/10/.

-SDG 7.1.2 impact is claimed by the number of households with access to clean to clean fuels and technology. In the monitoring period, 99.08% of the surveyed households claimed the use of project technology which is calculated to be 332,238 units out of total 335,313 units from the start date of the project. This is verified through verification from the record of distribution database as well as cross checked with site visit/10/ conducted to sampled household users.

-SDG 8.3.1 impact is claimed by the number of informal employments that is created by the project implementation. 3,239/29/ informal employments are claimed which is calculated using total employed personnel of DelAgua in various positions and locations that are working in VCS 3699 (and VCS 4150) divided equally. VCS 3699 is verified through Verra Registry (<https://registry.verra.org/app/projectDetail/VCS/4150>) which is verified located in the same area, same PP, same activity which is dissemination of improved cookstoves. PP's approach to divide the employed personals between the 2 projects is reasonable as the same personals are working for both projects.

-SDG 13 impact is claimed through the emission reduction calculated by the project implementation which the detailed assessment can be found in section 5.3 of this report.

-SDG 15.4 impact is claimed through the reduction firewood as the effect of project implementation. The claim is verified through calculation using number of ICS distributed, usage rate, By,savings and stove years. In total, 1,555,760 ton/9/ of wood savings are claimed in MP.

Additional information relevant to the project

No commercially sensitive information has been excluded by the PP.

4.2 Safeguards and Stakeholder Engagement

4.2.1 Stakeholder Identification

As confirmed with Project Proponent, the makeup of the stakeholders of the group project activities has not changed. The assessment is performed using project database distribution location as well as assessment of whether new project units distributed in the monitoring report are detected no detected with material discrepancies compared to previous monitoring reports.

Within the grouped project activities implementation in the monitoring report, no change is detected in terms of project location, type of technology, monitoring activities as well as changes detected in socio-economic condition within the project area.

The finding is consistent with the claim made by project proponent with the information reflected in section 2.1.1 of the monitoring report/8/.

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Stakeholder identification	N/A as stakeholder is identified to be the same as initial identification process as verified in project description document/5/.
Legal or customary tenure/access rights	The project activity does not involve land use, land access, or biomass harvesting rights. Cookstoves are distributed for voluntary use within individual households. No changes to legal or customary tenure or access rights were observed or reported. The verification team concludes that this requirement is not applicable to this project.
Stakeholder diversity and changes over time	Section 2.1.1 of the MR and verification interviews confirm that the project continues to engage a diverse range of stakeholders, including women, youth, and vulnerable households/8/10/. The demographic composition of stakeholders remains consistent with that identified during validation. No significant shifts or exclusions were noted during this monitoring period.
Expected changes in well-being	Evidence was drawn from the Monitoring Report and stakeholder interviews during the site visit. Reported co-benefits include reduced indoor air pollution, time savings in fuel collection, and reduced household fuel expenses. These impacts were consistently reported by ICS users and are in line with project expectations. The verification team finds the expected improvements to be credible and supported.

Location stakeholders	of	It has been observed and verified during on-site audit that the project activity is in line with the monitoring plan/5/ and there is no change in the location of stakeholders.
Location resources	of	The project does not involve access to or use of shared or contested natural resources. The ICS units operate independently within households and do not require external resource extraction. This criterion is not applicable to the project and was confirmed through field observations and MR review.

4.2.2 Stakeholder Consultation and Ongoing Communication

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Ongoing consultation	No additional stakeholder consultation was carried out in this monitoring period as the initial stakeholder has the same stakeholder composition as from the start of crediting period, only 1 PAI is included in the GP. PP has a continuous grievance mechanism/20/42/ in place for the local stakeholders. The beneficiaries of the project ICS have been provided with the following means to contact the PP: •Directly registering complains at the nearest cell office. •A toll-free helpline on which the end users can seek assistance. •Speaking to the DelAgua CHW network to share their feedbacks It is confirmed by PP that there has been no major grievances/complaints/42/ received in the monitoring period by the means of interview with stakeholder and implementation partner. However, the verification team would like to highlight that during the course of the verification process, Verra raised comments through the Project Review Report (PRR). In reference to Comment #6 concerning the missing information and assessment on ongoing communication, the following assessment is provided by the verification team based on a revision done in section 2.1.2 of revised MR, review of project documentation, field team interviews, and evidence gathered during the site visit. Assessment on stakeholder grievance and ongoing communication: 1: Periodic Household Visits Assessment: Based on review of the objective evidence and remote interview call with the project proponent, the VVB confirms the following: • The PP carried out periodic household visits between 22 June 2023 and 20 December 2024, involving 1,207 Community Health Workers (CHWs) who covered 118,667 households across target districts.

- The visits were designed to reinforce correct ICS usage, disseminate user-friendly materials (flipbooks, posters), and provide in-person support.
- These visits were also used as an active feedback mechanism, giving households the opportunity to raise concerns, which were documented or escalated when necessary.
- The Household Visit Report (Doc No. 29) was submitted by the PP and includes photographic records and visit tracking across districts.

The VVB concludes that the PP has implemented a robust, wide-scale household engagement process as part of its ongoing communication strategy. The documentation and on-site confirmations validate that these visits were conducted as stated, fulfilling the requirements of Section 2.1.2 and 2.1.4 of the MR.

2) Functionality of Grievance Redress Mechanism: Based on review of the objective evidence and remote interview call with the project proponent during the verification process, the VVB verified the following:

- The PP operates a multi-tiered grievance mechanism:
 - Toll-free number and website form for direct reporting;
 - In-person reporting via CHWs;
 - Grievance registers maintained at field offices.
- A consolidated grievance register (Doc No. 42) was submitted, reviewed, and found to contain entries regarding minor stove issues, usability questions, and requests for replacement parts.
- Field teams confirmed during interviews that grievances were either resolved directly by CHWs or escalated to PP's central technical support.
- Entries in the register included issue description, household name, CHW handling the case, and resolution status.

Therefore, VVB confirms that a functional and accessible grievance redress system is in place and has been used during the monitoring period. Documentation reviewed demonstrates resolution of all logged concerns, aligning with best practice requirements under the VCS Monitoring Report Template.

3) Updates to MR Section 2.1.2: Based on review of the objective evidence and remote interview call with the project proponent, the VVB confirmed the following:

- The PP revised Section 2.1.2 of the MR to comprehensively include:
 - Correct and accurate description of frequency and purpose of household visits.
 - Integration of field observations and user feedback into program design.
 - Linkage with grievance reporting and CHW-led

		communication channels. - The revised MR section now matches the information provided in Section 2.1.4 and aligns with project implementation records and verified field activities. - The MR clearly describes how this two-way communication is used to improve user support and ensure stove longevity and satisfaction. Therefore, the updated Section 2.1.2 now provides a complete and accurate reflection of the ongoing communication strategy, including household visits and grievance integration.
Date(s) of stakeholder consultation	of	No additional stakeholder consultation was executed in this MP
Communication monitored results	of	No major grievances/42/ received in this MP. From the site visit carried out by verifier team, it is confirmed that there is no inputs/complaints from users
Consultation records		PP claimed that there are no major inputs/grievances that is recorded that is relevant to project implementation process. The same is concluded from the data collected from users and stakeholder interviewed during site visit/10/.
Stakeholder input		PP claimed that there are no major inputs/grievances that is recorded that is relevant to project implementation process. The same is concluded from the data collected from users and stakeholder interviewed during site visit/10/.

4.2.3 Free, Prior, and Informed Consent

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Consent	From the communication channel established and communicated to project technology user through: •Directly registering complains at the nearest cell office. •A toll-free helpline on which the end users can seek assistance. •Speaking to the DelAgua CHW network to share their feedbacks

	From the information collected from site visit interviews with project technology users and project implementer partners' field team, no inputs/grievances/42/ that are identified that is evaluated to be material to project design and implementation. VCS standard/1/ para 3.18.8 is applicable in case the project is affecting property rights. The grouped project is an improved cookstove dissemination which is evaluated to have no risk on affecting any property right, Indigenous Peoples (IPs), local communities, nor customary rights
Outcome of FPIC discussion	No concerns or objections regarding participation were reported. The verification team concludes that FPIC was appropriately obtained and documented in line with the VCS Program and project safeguards.

4.2.4 Grievance Redress Procedure

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Grievance received and steps taken to resolve the grievance including the outcomes of the resolution	The verification team conducted on-site assessments and interacted with local stakeholders, as detailed in section 2.3 of the report. Notably, no negative comments or feedback were received from the local stakeholders during these interactions, according to the verification team's records. The PP has a continuous grievance mechanism/42/20/ in place for the local stakeholders. The beneficiaries of the project ICS have been provided with the following means to contact the PP: •Directly registering complains at the nearest cell office. •A toll-free helpline on which the end users can seek assistance. •Speaking to the DelAgua CHW network to share their feedbacks VVB has conducted interviews with the PP representatives and the end users and found that there was the constant on-going communication directly with the beneficiary households. The project proponent has disclosed its feedback and grievance redressal mechanism under section 2.1.2 - 2.1.4 of the MR/8/.

It is crucial to emphasize that the responsibility for addressing grievances related to the grouped project activity is shared between the local implementation partners and the project proponent.

Any grievances that arise during the operation of the grouped project activity will be conveyed to the project proponent for resolution. To facilitate ongoing communication with stakeholders, an established grievance mechanism is in place.

Based on interviews and observations, the assessment team evaluated that the grievance redressal procedure adequately addresses issues that may arise during project planning and implementation. Beneficiaries and stakeholders are provided with the project proponent's contact information and are encouraged to reach out with any problems, questions, or grievances.

During the current monitoring period, no major grievance/42/ is claimed received. The same is concluded from the site visit (interviews with users).

As part of the verification process for the current monitoring period, the verification team confirms that no major grievances were received from project stakeholders or end-users. This conclusion is based on a review of the grievance register, interviews conducted with field staff and Community Health Workers (CHWs), as well as direct engagement with sampled beneficiary households during the site visit conducted by VVB team.

The grievance redress mechanism was assessed in accordance with the requirements of VM0050 v1.0 and the VCS Standard v4.7. The mechanism includes multiple accessible channels such as a toll-free helpline, in-person reporting to local CHWs, and a grievance register maintained at local offices. The functionality and awareness of these channels were confirmed through stakeholder interviews and household visits.

The grievance register was made available to the VVB during the verification and is listed under document No. 42 in Appendix 2 of the Final Verification Report (FVR). The review of this register confirmed that there were no concerns raised during the period. No unresolved or significant issues were identified that could impact the eligibility or implementation of the project activity.

Grievance redress procedure	PP has a continuous grievance mechanism in place for the local stakeholders. The beneficiaries of the project ICS have been provided with the following means to contact the PP: Directly register complaints at the nearest cell office. •A toll-free helpline on which the end users can seek assistance. •Speaking to the DelAgua CHW network to share their feedbacks Activities of the field team is presented in form of log of activities extracted from internal data monitoring 'DM_ADM Log Location'/21/ which includes household visits & trainings in which grievances can be collected. From the information collected from site visit interviews with project technology users and project implementer partners' field team, no inputs/grievances that are identified that is evaluated to be material to project design and implementation. VCS standard/1/ para 3.18.8 is applicable in case the project is affecting property rights. The grouped project is an improved cookstove dissemination which is evaluated to have no risk on affecting any property right, Indigenous Peoples (IPs), local communities, nor customary rights
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4.2.5 Public Comments

Comments received	Actions taken by the project proponent	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
From the evidence gathered, no public comment has been received	N/A	N/A

4.2.6 Risks to Local Stakeholders and the Environment

4.2.6.1 Management Experience

It was confirmed during the onsite visit that the DelAgua staff are well-trained, with prior experience in distribution and monitoring. They received training on the questionnaire before conducting the surveys. The Training records and personnel competency have been verified by the assessment team during the onsite visit/10/

4.2.6.2 Risk Assessment

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Natural and human induced risks to stakeholders' wellbeing	During the onsite visit/10/ interview with of the personnel and stakeholders was conducted where they confirmed that climate crises and natural disasters can precipitate displacement and migration, resulting in the relocation of households. Further they added that the group project involved distribution of ICS that are portable and lightweight. Consequently, users of the project's ICS could easily carry them in case relocation becomes necessary. The structure of ICS was verified onsite, and end users were interviewed to verify the risk associated. No Risk was detected with respect to the project activity
Risks to stakeholder participation	From the communication channel established and communicated to project technology user through several mechanisms: Directly register complaints at the nearest cell office. •A toll-free helpline on which the end users can seek assistance. •Speaking to the DelAgua CHW network to share their feedbacks With this communication approach in place, inputs from stakeholders are able to be received, collected and follow up upon. Project proponent also clarified that communication can take place following normal tribal route where beneficiaries log the grievance with their tribal leader which then shall notify field team to log the grievances and follow up on it. From the information collected from site visit interviews with project technology users and project implementer partners' field team, no inputs/grievances/42/ that are identified that is evaluated to be material to project design and implementation

Working conditions	No risk identified. DelAgua internal policies and Handbook which are mandatory to be signed by employed personals/17/ is verified. Rwanda has Labor Law in effect /23/ in place that cover employee's right. No issues detected from the interviewed personals during the site visit/10/.
Safety of women and girls	No risk identified. No issues detected from the interviewed personals during the site visit/10/. The nature of the project is through the dissemination of improved cookstove which based on technology performance claimed from manufacturer and perceived stove performance from user from monitoring survey/12/ and cross checked through verifier's site visit/10/, the project implementation benefits women and girls through reduction of smoke during meal preparation and shorter cooking time.
Safety of minority and marginalized groups, including children	No risk identified, PP have code of conduct and policy in place in relevant to hiring workers under legal age as well as Rwanda Labor Law/23/ in effect. No evidence is detected from the site visit and interaction between verifier team and monitoring field team.
Pollutants (air, noise, discharges to water, generation and release of hazardous materials and chemical pesticides and fertilizers)	No risk identified. Project technology BURN which is provided with manufacturer's technology specification which is verified through BURN Website/26/ with higher thermal efficiency which in effect reduces wood fuel usage. The project technology utilize wood fuel and operate as cookstove which does not generate more waste than baseline stove. Based on perception of users as verified from monitoring survey, majority of the users claimed less smoke is generated from the project stove i.e. 99.21%.

4.2.7 Respect for Human Rights and Equity

4.2.7.1 Labor and Work

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
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Discrimination	No risk identified. Rwanda has Labor Law in effect/22/ in place that cover employee's right. PP their own internal code of conduct and policy in place which covers both discrimination and sexual harassment issues/16/. No issues detected from the interviewed personals during the site visit/10/.
Sexual harassment	No risk identified. Rwanda has Labor Law in effect/22/ in place that cover employee's right. PP their own internal code of conduct and policy in place which covers both discrimination and sexual harassment issues/17/. No issues detected from the interviewed personals during the site visit/10/.
Gender equity in labor and work	No risk identified. Rwanda has Labor Law in effect/22/ in place that cover employee's right. PP their own internal code of conduct and policy in place which covers both discrimination and sexual harassment issues/16/. No issues detected from the interviewed personals during the site visit/10/.
Forced labor	No risk identified. Rwanda has Labor Law in effect/22/ in place that cover employee's right. PP their own internal code of conduct and policy in place which forced labor/16/. No issues detected from the interviewed personals during the site visit/10/.
Child labor	No risk identified. Rwanda has Labor Law in effect/22/ in place that cover employee's right. PP their own internal code of conduct and policy in place which child labor/16/. No issues detected from the interviewed personals during the site visit/10/.
Human trafficking	No risk identified. Rwanda has Labor Law in effect/22/ in place that cover employee's right. PP their own internal code of conduct and policy in place which covers human trafficking/16/. No issues detected from the interviewed personals during the site visit/10/.

4.2.7.2 Human Rights

Risks identified	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Human Rights	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove which presents no risk to Human Rights. The employed worker's rights are assessed in section 4.2.7.1. Rwanda has been a member of ILO since 1962 which summary of the ratifications over the years by the country/33/.

4.2.7.3 Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage

Risks identified	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
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Preservation and protection of cultural heritage	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove which present no risk to Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage
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4.2.7.4 Property Rights

Risks identified	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Disputes over rights to territories and resources	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove which present no risk to property rights. Through signed user agreements it is clearly communicated that the stove is distributed free of charge and in return the credit for claiming carbon emission reduction is with PP. Assessment of the project based on the project technology and activities was executed against applicable Financial rules and regulations/30/, and international human rights laws and standards/33/.
Respect for property rights	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove which presents no risk to property rights.

4.2.7.5 Benefit Sharing

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Summary of the benefit sharing plan	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove which present no risk to property rights. Through signed user agreements it is clearly communicated that the stove is distributed free of charge and in return the credit for claiming carbon emission reduction is with PP.
Benefit sharing during the monitoring period	N/A. The nature of the project implementation does not have benefit sharing arrangement through all parties involved.

4.2.8 Ecosystem Health

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
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Impacts on biodiversity and ecosystems	N/A. The nature of the project is implementation through the dissemination of improved cookstove to replace the traditional baseline stove. The project implementation has no effect on biodiversity and ecosystem. Through use of improved cookstove, reduction in wood fuel consumption can serve a positive impact on the surrounding ecosystem.
Soil degradation and soil erosion	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove to replace the traditional baseline stove. The project implementation has no effect on biodiversity and ecosystem. Through use of improved cookstove, wood fuel consumption reduction can serve a positive impact on surrounding ecosystem.
Water consumption and stress	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove to replace the traditional baseline stove. The use of project technology has no impact on water consumption since it is simply aimed to replace the use of baseline stove.

4.2.8.1 Rare, Threatened, and Endangered species

Item	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
Species or habitat	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove to replace the traditional baseline stove which does not present risk for local species or habitat. .
Areas needed for habitat connectivity	N/A.

4.2.8.2 Introduction of Species

Species introduced	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
N/A	

Existing invasive species	Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion
N/A	

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Evidence gathering activities, evidence checked, and assessment conclusion	
Invasive species	N/A

4.2.8.3 Ecosystem conversion

Item	Evidence gathering activities and evidence checked
Ecosystem conversion	N/A. The nature of the project implementation is through the dissemination of improved cookstove to replace the traditional baseline stove which does not present as risk to local ecosystem.

4.3 Accuracy of Reduction and Removal Calculations

The monitoring has been carried out in accordance with the provision of monitoring plan; the verification team reviewed if:

- The monitoring of reductions in GHG emissions resulting from the VCS project activity is verified against the monitoring plan contained in the registered VCS-PD/5/ and the updated methodology/7/.
- All parameters stated in the monitoring plan, the applied/updated methodologies and relevant
- standards and requirements have been sufficiently monitored and updated.
- The responsibilities and authorities for monitoring and reporting were in accordance with the responsibilities and authorities stated in the monitoring plan.

The monitoring system and all applied procedures are in compliance with the monitoring plan contained in the revised VCS-PD/41/ and the updated methodology VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0 /7/, based on the information included in the final monitoring report, there are several procedures for data collecting depending on the methodology applicable for each step of the project.

PP conducted sampling surveys to gather information needed for the monitoring of nj,k,y, ηnew,avg,y and BCp,j,k,y parameters.

Where,

nj,k,y: Visual inspection of the premises to see if ICS is operational and in use. Interview with end user if required to verify that ICS is still in use (Yes/No)

$\eta_{new,avg,y}$: WBT tests were conducted in the sampled households.

BCp,j,k,y : Project KPTs were conducted in the sampled households

Monitoring surveys were conducted in December 2024. Minimum sample size is calculated and verified for each parameter and PAI in reference to CDM Guideline Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and PoA/26/ using total distributed units as target population. Using stratified random sampling approach, PP has identified different sample sets for different parameters.

Parameter	Calculated minimum samples needed	Actual Samples Surveyed the listed parameters
$\eta_{j,k,y}$	43	126
$\eta_{new,avg,y}$	8	13
BCp,j,k,y	47	116

The verification team notes that during the course of the verification process, Verra raised observations through the Project Review Report (PRR). In relation to Comment #2 regarding the completeness of the end-user database and the representativeness of the sampling records for the entire database and the full monitoring period, the following assessment is provided by the verification team. This conclusion is based on a thorough review of project documentation, interviews with field personnel, and evidence collected during the site visit.

1) Review and Validation of the End-User Database

- In accordance with Section 9.3 of VM0050 v1.0, the VVB confirms that the complete ICS distribution database containing individual-level household data such as names, addresses, contact details, and stove serial numbers, was shared directly with the VVB and thoroughly reviewed.
- Due to the sensitive nature of the data, the Project Proponent (PP) has rightly withheld this information from the public ERR spreadsheet, in compliance with Rwanda's Law No. 058/2021 on Personal Data and Privacy as well as international data protection regulations (GDPR, UK DPA 2018). Therefore, its exclusion from the public spreadsheet does not compromise transparency or auditability.
- The VVB accessed the full database during a remote desktop session, during which:
 - a) The PP demonstrated secure access to the ICS distribution server.
 - b) The VVB downloaded the full database and conducted random sampling checks.
 - c) Fields including household name, address, GPS coordinates, stove ID, distribution date, and user agreements were verified.
 - d) The database structure and completeness were cross validated with the ER spreadsheet summaries (ICS Distribution Summary tab) and other monitoring records.
- The full database is referenced in Appendix 2 of the Final Verification Report (FVR), Document No. 11, confirming its use during verification.

Therefore, it is concluded by VVB team that T complete end-user database was securely shared

and reviewed during verification, in compliance with VM0050 Section 9.3. Due to personal data protection laws in Rwanda and internationally, end-user details were not included in the public ERR spreadsheet. However, the VVB accessed the full database via secure remote session, performed random checks, and verified data accuracy. The exclusion from the ERR does not affect transparency or compliance.

2) Assessment of Sampling Date and Representativeness: VVB team would like to confirm here that:

- a) The final stove distribution under the project took place on 27 July 2023, as verified from the “ICS Distribution Summary” tab in the ER sheet and the database itself.
- b) No distributions occurred in 2024, a fact cross-confirmed via interviews with the field team and database inspection.
- c) The sampling for the usage and performance survey was conducted on 10 December 2024, one week prior to survey deployment.
- d) This timeline ensures that:
 - o The entire ICS distribution database was finalized before sampling.
 - o No additional stoves were distributed after the sample frame was generated, thus eliminating risk of under-coverage or post-sampling bias.
- e) This approach aligns with VM0050 v1.0, Section 9.3, which requires sampling to be representative of the full monitored population and to reflect conditions during the monitoring period.
- f) The sampling date is now explicitly included in Section 4.3 of the Monitoring Report, as required by the finding.

Verification Methodology for Representativeness

- During the site audit (18–21 March 2025), the VVB verified:
 - o Sample representativeness by randomly selecting and auditing households across two districts (Huye and Nyabihu).
 - o Both project stove users and baseline households were visited and interviewed, confirming accurate inclusion in the master database.
 - o The survey population’s geographic and temporal spread matched the distribution activity recorded in the database.
- The sampling methodology applied by the PP, including stratified random sampling, is consistent with CDM’s “Sampling and Survey Guidelines” and was verified the approach as permitted under the Sampling Standard Version 9.0.

Therefore, as stated above it is concluded by VVB team that the sampling was conducted, after the final ICS distribution. No distributions occurred after this date, ensuring the sampling frame was complete and representative of the entire monitoring period. This information has been included in Section 4.3 of the Monitoring Report. The sampling process fully aligns with VM0050 Section 9.3 and is therefore considered valid and compliant

PP's calculation for sample size is presented (for detailed assessment refer update in section 2.4 of FVR for PRR comment #9) in transparent spreadsheet in ER calculation/9/ tab Sample Size Cal & Results.

Sampling captured information on monitoring variables with required confidence/precision

95/10 confidence/precision basis in corresponding to the scale of the Group Project which is large project in accordance to VCS Standard/1/ and CDM Guideline Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and PoA/26/.

Accuracy and data traceability from the presented survey data is requested to be demonstrated by PP from the internal data management system to the extracted spreadsheet. Data presented and used for ER calculation is concluded to be complete and accurate. PP further provided justification and rationale behind data interpretation from the survey data during the opening meeting.

Calculation for relative precision from survey data is calculated at for both monitored parameters $n_{j,k,y}$, $\eta_{new,avg,y}$ and $BC_{p,j,k,y}$ is presented in the ER calculation/9/ tab Sample Size Cal & Results and final result tab in VCS 3699 MP2 Project Device KPT Analysis spreadsheet/40/.

Verifier team approach to determine sample site visit in terms of minimum sample as well as sample selection is detailed in section 2.4. of this report.

Details of the sampled users are detailed in section 2.3 of the verification report. Data collected from the site visit on the sampled survey/10/ verified against monitoring survey^{/12/} and project distribution database/11/.

Parameter $n_{j,k,y}$, $\eta_{new,avg,y}$ and $BC_{p,j,k,y}$, are verified to be matching the monitoring data survey.

Parameter	Description of Parameter	Assessment approach
$n_{j,k,y}$	Number of project devices of type i	-Visual inspection of the premises to see if the project stove is operational and in use. -Interview with end user to verify that project stove is still in use
$\eta_{new,avg,y}$	Weighted average efficiency of project devices in year y (fraction)	Interview with end user and reviewed WBT reports submitted by PP for all 13 project samples.

BCp,j,k,y	Weighted average efficiency of project devices in year y (fraction)	Onsite interview with households and reviewed 116 KPTs submitted by PP
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Verifier team carried out the site visit concluded that from 8 sampled households for project stove and 8 sampled households for baseline stoves reassessed in accordance with VM0050, no discrepancy sighted between the data collected from site visit/10/ with monitoring data reported by PP. This finding satisfied para 33 of CDM Sampling and surveys for CDM project activities and programmes of activities/18/, thus the coordinating/managing entities' set of records is accepted.

Emission reduction (ER)

The methodology calculates baseline and project emissions separately. The steps taken and the equations and parameters applied in the VCS-PD/05/ and VM0050 to calculate the project emissions, baseline emissions, leakage and emission reductions comply with the requirements of the selected methodology including applicable tool(s).

$$BE_y = \sum EC_{i,y} \times N_{j,k,y} \times n_{j,k,y} \times (EF_{b,i,CO_2} \times f_{NRB,y} + EF_{b,i,nonCO_2}) \quad \text{Equation (1)}$$

Where:

BE_y	Baseline emissions during year y (t CO ₂ e)
$EC_{i,y}$	Average energy consumption of baseline device type i in year y (TJ)
$N_{j,k,y}$	Number of commissioned project devices of type j from batch k in year y
$n_{j,k,y}$	Proportion of commissioned project devices of type j from batch k that remain operating in year y (fraction)
EF_{b,i,CO_2}	CO ₂ emission factor for fuel used by baseline device type i in the baseline scenario (t CO ₂ /TJ)
$f_{NRB,y}$	Fraction of woody biomass that is established to be non-renewable used by baseline device in year y (fraction)
$EF_{b,i,nonCO_2}$	Non-CO ₂ emission factor for fuel used by baseline device type i in the baseline scenario (t CO ₂ e/TJ)
i	Baseline device type and its respective fuel type

j Project device type and its respective fuel type

The average energy consumption of baseline device type i is calculated as follows:

$$EC_{i,y} = BC_{b,i,y} \times NCV_{b,i} \quad \text{Equation (2)}$$

Where:

$BC_{b,i,y}$ Fuel used per baseline device type i during year y (tonnes)
 $NCV_{b,i}$ Net calorific value of baseline fuel for baseline device type i (TJ/tonne)

Cross-check of $EC_{i,y}$ to address stove stacking:

Baseline consumption from the back calculation is calculated as follows:

$$EC_{est,y} = EC_{p,y} \times \eta_{new,avg,y} / \eta_{old,avg} \quad \text{Equation (3)}$$

Where:

$EC_{est,y}$ Back-calculated energy consumption of the potential mix of devices and fuels in the baseline in year y (TJ)
 $EC_{p,y}$ Energy used in project scenario by project devices during year y (TJ)
 $\eta_{new,avg,y}$ Weighted average efficiency of project devices in year y (fraction)
 $\eta_{old,avg}$ Weighted average efficiency of baseline devices that are replaced by project devices (fraction)

Note: Where the results indicate that baseline consumption ($EC_{i,y}$) is higher than that indicated by back-calculation from the project scenario ($EC_{est,y}$) then the back-calculation results ($EC_{est,y}$) will be applied in Equation (1) as a conservative cap.

$$EC_{p,y} = \sum_{j,k} BC_{p,j,k,y} \times NCV_{p,j} \quad \text{Equation (4)}$$

Where:

$BC_{p,j,k,y}$ Average quantity of fuel used by project device type j from batch k during year y (tonnes or m³)

$NCV_{p,i}$ Net calorific value of project fuel used in project device type I
(TJ/tonne or TJ/m³)

Given that the grouped project involves the distribution of non-renewable biomass-based improved cookstoves exclusively to the target users, Equation (5) of the methodology applies to electric stoves and is therefore not applicable

Quantification of leakage emissions:

In accordance with the section 8.3 of the applied methodology, VM0050, version 1.0/7/ a default factor of 0.95 to account for leakage has been applied.

Verification team confirms that all relevant assumptions and data are listed in the project description, including their references and sources and that all data and parameter values used in the project description are considered reasonable in the context of the project and all estimates of the baseline emissions can be replicated using the data and parameter values provided in the project description. No uncertainties associated with the calculations of emissions have been observed by the verification team.

Quantification of project emissions:

As per the applied methodology VM0050, ver. 1.0, project emissions are calculated as follows:

$$PE_y = PE_{energy,y} + PE_{others,y}$$

Equation (6)

Where:

PE_y	Project emissions during year y (t CO ₂ e)
$PE_{energy,y}$	Project emissions from energy consumption of project devices in year y (t CO ₂ e)
$PE_{others,y}$	Project emissions from other sources in year y (t CO ₂ e)

$$PE_{energy,y} = \sum_j \sum_k BC_{p,j,k,y} \times N_{j,k,y} \times NCV_{p,j} \times nj_{k,y} \times (EF_{p,j,CO_2} \times f_{NRB,y} + EF_{p,j,nonCO_2}) \text{ Equation (7)}$$

Where:

EF_{p,j,CO2} CO₂ emission factor for fuel used by project device type j in the project scenario (t CO₂/TJ) = 112 tCO₂e/TJ (Meth Default Value)

EF_{p,j,nonCO2} Non-CO₂ emission factor for fuel used by project device type j in the project scenario (t CO₂e/TJ) = 9.46 tCO₂e/TJ (Meth Default Value)

Given that the grouped project involves the distribution of non-renewable biomass-based improved cookstoves exclusively to the target users, Equation (8) and Equation (10) of the methodology applies to electric stoves and are therefore not applicable. Further, the ICS distributed under the project is designed for wood fuel, and beneficiaries procure the wood fuel either from nearby fields or the market. Therefore, Equation (9) is not applicable.

Verifier team has reviewed the project KPTs and confirms there are no uncertainties in calculating BC_{p,j,k,y} for project emission calculations.

The grouped project employs methodology namely VM0050⁷¹ v1.1. Following Project Description Document /5/ section 5.1 and 5.2, the parameters determined ex-ante and monitored ex-post as per methodology requirements are as followed:

The data and parameters fixed (ex-ante):

S.No	Parameter	Value	Means of verification
1	EF _{b,i,CO2} , EF _{p,j,CO2} , EF _{fuel,hCO2} CO ₂ Emission factor for fuel used by baseline device type i in the baseline scenario CO ₂ Emission factor for fuel used by project device type j in the project scenario Emission factor for fuel used by backup generator h	112 tCO ₂ e/TJ	Verification against methodology default value and IPCC Guidelines/25/
2	EF _{b,i,nonCO2} EF _{p,j,nonCO2}	9.46 tCO ₂ e/TJ	Verification against methodology default value and IPCC Guidelines/25/

	Non-CO₂ emission factor for fuel used by baseline device type i in the baseline scenario Non-CO₂ emission factor for fuel used by project device type j in the project scenario		
3	NCV_{b,i} NCV_{p,j} NCV_h Net calorific value of baseline fuel used by baseline device type i Net calorific value of project fuel used by project device type j Net calorific value of fuel used by backup generator	Wood: 0.0156 TJ/tonne	Verification against methodology default value and IPCC Guidelines/25/
4	BC_{ex-ante,b,i} Ex-ante annual average quantity of fuel used per baseline	4.04 tonnes/year	Assessment team has reviewed baseline KPTs as per VM0050 v1.0 requirements and cross check firewood consumption during onsite
5	$\eta_{old,avg}$ Weighted average efficiency of baseline devices that are replaced by project devices	15%	Verification against methodology default value and IPCC Guidelines/25/
6	H_{hi} H_{hj,k}	Average household size of the target population using device type i is 4.31	Assessment team has reviewed baseline survey and KPTs as per VM0050 v1.0 requirements and cross check firewood consumption during onsite

		Average household size of the target population using device type j from batch k	
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The data and parameters monitored (ex-post):

1. Parameter: $N_{y,k,y}$ (Number of commissioned project devices of type j from batch k in year y)

Means of verification	Measuring /Reading /Recording frequency	Assessemnt team has reviewed total ICS distribution database following methodology ^{/7/} requirement. As per methodology ^{/7/} requirement and PD ^{/5/} , the monitoring frequency is Every time that new project devices are distributed. Frequency monitoring for this parameter is evident meeting the methodology requirement.
	Is measuring and reporting frequency in accordance with the monitoring plan and monitoring methodology? (Yes / No)	N/A. This is based on distribution records of ICS.
	Monitoring equipment	N/A. This is based on distribution records of ICS.
	Is accuracy of the monitoring equipment as stated in the monitoring plan? If the monitoring plan does not specify the accuracy of the monitoring equipment, does the accuracy of the monitoring equipment comply with local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specification?	N/A
	Calibration frequency /interval:	This is based on distribution records of ICS.

	Is the calibration interval in line with the monitoring plan and/or methodology? If the monitoring plan does not specify the frequency of calibration, is the selected frequency in accordance with the local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specifications?	N/A
	Is the calibration of measuring equipment carried out by an accredited person or institution?	N/A
	Is(are) calibration(s) valid for the whole reporting period?	N/A
	How were the values in the monitoring report verified?	Assessment team has reviewed the total distribution database which has date of distribution. VVB has also verified CTF for the selected households. Value of $N_{j,k,y}$ is verified as 335,313 units
	If applicable, has the reported data been cross checked with other available data?	N/A
	Does the data management ensure correct transfer of data and reporting of emission reductions and necessary QA/QC processes in place?	Assessment team has reviewed number of ICS devices recorded in database, sales record. Value of $N_{j,k,y}$ is verified as 335,313 units
	In case project participants have temporarily not monitored the parameter, has either deviation?	Monitoring is verified to be carried out as per Project Description Document ^{/5/} and methodology ^{/7/} requirement with no deviation.
Findings	NA	
Conclusion	Total distribution database was crosschecked with sales record and CTF. Total project stove commissioned are accepted as: 335,313 units	

2. Parameter: nj,k,y (Proportion of commissioned project devices of type j from batch k that are still being used regularly in year y)

Means verification	of Measuring /Reading /Recording frequency	Following methodology/7/ requirement, the parameter is measured directly or based on a representative sample. Project Proponent carried out habit survey/12/ with questionnaire determining whether project technology is used (user vs non-user) for each project instances sample sets. Calculation is carried out for the project instance using total units distributed with usage rate % from monitoring survey. As per methodology/7/ requirement and PD/5/, the monitoring frequency is annually. The parameter is calculated using usage rate obtained from monitoring survey carried out in Dec 2024 for MP2 As per methodology/7/ requirement and PD/5/, the monitoring frequency is annual. The parameter is calculated using usage rate obtained from monitoring survey carried out in Dec 2024 for MP2. Sampling requirement for the survey to obtain the data parameter is assessed with presented data that Project Proponent sampling plan is adjusted to satisfy sample size to achieve 95/10 confidence precision relevant to the size of the project. Sampling approach adopted by Project proponent is in line with Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and Programmes of Activities requirement/17/.
	Is measuring and reporting frequency in accordance with the monitoring plan and monitoring methodology? (Yes / No)	As per methodology/7/ requirement and PD/5/, the monitoring frequency is annually. The parameter is calculated using usage rate obtained from monitoring survey carried out in Dec 2024 for MP2 and in Dec 2022. Sampling requirement for the survey to obtain the data parameter is assessed with presented data that Project Proponent sampling plan is adjusted to satisfy sample size to achieve 95/10 confidence precision relevant to the size of the project. Sampling approach adopted by Project proponent in accordance with Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and Programmes of Activities requirement/18/
	Monitoring equipment	N/A. The parameter is calculated using equation 5 of the methodology.

	Is accuracy of the monitoring equipment as stated in the monitoring plan? If the monitoring plan does not specify the accuracy of the monitoring equipment, does the accuracy of the monitoring equipment comply with local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specification?	N/A
	Calibration frequency /interval:	N/A, no equipment is used as the parameter is calculated using total stove distributed multiplied with usage rate derived from monitoring survey (survey habit/14/).
	Is the calibration interval in line with the monitoring plan and/or methodology? If the monitoring plan does not specify the frequency of calibration, is the selected frequency in accordance with the local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specifications?	N/A

	Is the calibration of measuring equipment carried out by an accredited person or institution?	N/A
	Is(are) calibration(s) valid for the whole reporting period?	N/A
	How were the values in the monitoring reports verified?	Stove Operating Fraction for determination of $N_{y,i,j}$ values are verified through data analysis of data presented as survey habit/12/ for each project instances for usage rate of project technology is at 99.08%. The usage rate was capped to 90% in accordance VM0050. Details can be seen in CL#13. PP has submitted monitoring usage survey under usage survey data tab of the ER spreadsheet. The verification team would like to highlight that during the course of the verification process, Verra raised comments through the Project Review Report (PRR). In reference to Comment#4.7 concerning the usage rate, the following assessment is provided by the verification team based on a review of project documentation, field team interviews, and evidence gathered during the site visit. Justification for Application of 90% Usage Rate Cap under VM0050 v1.0 Clarification #2: The VVB has reviewed the Project Proponent's application of a 90% cap on the usage rate (parameter $n_{j,k,y}$) and assessed the project's compliance with the requirements outlined under Clarification #2 of the VM0050 v1.0 Corrections and Clarifications document. Clarification #2 stipulates that the 90% cap may only be applied if the project meets all of the following three criteria: 1. Selection of Technologies and Fuels that Fully Meet Cooking Needs • The VVB reviewed Section 3.4 of the Project Description (PD) and verified that the primary cooking fuel for the target rural population in Rwanda is firewood, consistent with the Fifth Rwanda Population and Housing Census (2022), which states that 94% of rural households rely on firewood.

		- Technology Deployed: The project distributed Kuniokoa Generation 2 improved cookstoves, engineered for firewood, specifically to replace the traditional three-stone or rudimentary wood stoves. Therefore, it is confirmed by VVB team that the stove model and fuel type directly match the baseline cooking needs and practices of the population. The VVB verified this through review of the baseline survey, national census data, and field interviews conducted during the on-site audit. 2. Support Activities to Assist Effective Operation and Maintenance - The VVB verified multiple layers of support mechanisms implemented by the PP: - Poster Agreements: Each end user received a poster in the local language at the time of distribution with visual instructions on correct usage and maintenance. - Training Flipbook: During household visits, field teams used a 16-page Tubebo Neza Flipbook in the local language, covering usage, maintenance, and troubleshooting. - Demonstrations: Field staff conducted live demonstrations of stove use and maintenance during distribution events and follow-up visits. The VVB reviewed samples of the flipbook, training materials, and household visit photos, all of which were submitted as Appendix 2, Document No. 29 of the FVR. Interviews with CHWs and field staff corroborated the implementation of these support activities. Therefore, it is confirmed by VVB team that these sustained and multilingual training efforts, supported by documented evidence and verified during on-site audits, demonstrate full compliance. 3. Provision of a Toll-Free Communication Channel for Support - The VVB reviewed Sections 2.1.4 of the PD and MR and confirmed that a toll-free helpline is operational and widely communicated to end users. - The helpline is featured on the poster agreement and reiterated during household visits. Households and CHWs interviewed during the field audit confirmed awareness of and access to this helpline. - The existence and functioning of a toll-free support line ensures accessibility to maintenance and grievance redressal mechanisms. This criterion is fully met.
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	4. Overall Determination and Usage Rate Verification The VVB concludes that the project demonstrably and verifiably meets all three criteria outlined under Clarification #2 of the VM0050 v1.0 Corrections and Clarifications. The use of a 90% usage rate cap is therefore fully justified. The VVB also confirms that this justification is explicitly documented in the parameter table for nj,k,y under Section 4.2 of the MR and was validated through documentation review and on-site field verification. Therefore, it is concluded by VVB team that the application of the 90% usage rate cap by the Project Proponent complies with the requirements of VM0050 and its clarifications and is accepted by the VVB.	
	If applicable, has the reported data been cross checked with other available data?	NA, as this is a calculated value using methodology equation.
	Does the data management ensure correct transfer of data and reporting of emission reductions and are necessary in place?	The value of usage survey is based on the monitoring survey analysis which is captured and recorded electronically. Traceability of the data from the presented excel data file/12/ was performed from the data source using sampled data set during opening meeting with no discrepancy sighted. Similar feedback from households is obtained during onsite visits. Calculation of the value is verified as well as the value claimed in both ER/9/ and QA/QC processes monitoring report/8/.
	In case project participants have temporarily not monitored the parameter, has either deviation?	Monitoring is verified to be carried out as per Project Description Document^{/5/} and methodology^{/7/} requirement with no deviation.
Findings	CL#13	
Conclusion	The raised CLs were resolved satisfactorily. The value of this parameter is verified and accepted as:	

	Value Applied is 0.9
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3. Parameter fnrb,b,y (Fraction of woody biomass that can be established as non-renewable biomass.)

Means of verification	Measuring /Reading /Recording frequency	In accordance with VM0050 requirement, fNRB value registered in PD is multiplied with uncertainty discount of 26%. Value of the Parameter is verified through registered PD and previous verification report. Please refer CL #14 for further details. This parameter must be fixed ex ante for 1st crediting period. The calculation of this parameter is found to be in accordance with the updated methodology.
	Is measuring and reporting frequency in accordance with the monitoring plan and monitoring methodology? (Yes / No)	Calculation of this parameter is as per updated methodology. CL #14 provide further details on selection of method to calculate the value. This parameter is calculated once per crediting period. The frequency of calculation of fNRB for the host country is in line with VM0050 v1.0.
	Monitoring equipment	N/A. The parameter is calculated as per tool 30 (already in registered PD) multiplied by uncertainty discount of 26%.
	Is accuracy of the monitoring equipment as stated in the monitoring plan? If the monitoring plan does not specify the accuracy of the monitoring equipment, does the accuracy of the monitoring equipment comply with local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specification?	N/A
	Calibration frequency /interval:	N/A

	Is the calibration interval in line with the monitoring plan and/or methodology? If the monitoring plan does not specify the frequency of calibration, is the selected frequency in accordance with the local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specifications?	N/A
	Is the calibration of measuring equipment carried out by an accredited person or institution?	N/A
	Is(are) calibration(s) valid for the whole reporting period?	N/A
	How were the values in the monitoring report verified?	Calculation of this parameter is as per updated methodology. CL #14 provide further details on selection of method to calculated the value. This parameter is calculated once per crediting period.
	If applicable, has the reported data been cross checked with other available data?	N/A Calculation of this parameter is as per updated methodology. CL #14 provide further details on selection of method to calculated the value. This parameter is calculated once per crediting period. The frequency of calculation of fNRB for the host country is in line with VM0050 v1.0.
	Does the data management ensure correct transfer of data and reporting of emission reductions and are necessary QA/QC processes in place?	N/A. The parameter is as per registered PD. fNRB is updated in accordance with section 9.2 of the updated methodology. Please refer to CL #14.
	In case project participants have temporarily not monitored the parameter, has either deviation?	N/A. The parameter is as per registered PD. fNRB is updated in accordance with section 9.2 of the updated methodology.
Findings	CL #14	
Conclusion	The raised CLs were resolved satisfactorily.	

	The value of this parameter is verified and accepted as: 0.6565
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4. Parameter BC_{b,i,y} (Fuel used per baseline device type i during year y)

Means of verification	Measuring /Reading /Recording frequency	Following methodology^{7/} requirement, the parameter is to be obtained from survey at five years. The parameter is to be monitored using 2 options with option 1 being used. This option requires measurement campaign followed by KPTs that are not the part of the project activity. Similar sampling procedures to the project scenario were followed and 126 samples in the baseline were surveyed followed by 116 KPTs. The fuel consumption was confirmed by interviews of baseline households during onsite visit. The monitoring frequency is in line with updated methodology. Please refer to CL #8 for details.
	Is measuring and reporting frequency in accordance with the monitoring plan and monitoring methodology? (Yes / No)	Following methodology^{7/} requirement, under option 1 the parameter is to be obtained from survey designed to capture the cooking habits and baseline firewood consumption of households in project boundary. Please refer to CL #8 for details. Assessment team has reviewed the sampling approach and the baseline survey data. The estimate wood consumption in the baseline was confirmed by baseline households during onsite visit. The approach PP has implemented based on the questionnaire format of the survey, data interpretation and analysis for precision level, it is concluded to satisfy methodology requirement^{7/}.

	Monitoring equipment	NA, as the survey data is obtained by verbal confirmation and is followed by KPT.
	Is accuracy of the monitoring equipment as stated in the monitoring plan? If the monitoring plan does not specify the accuracy of the monitoring equipment, does the accuracy of the monitoring equipment comply with local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specification?	NA, as the survey data is obtained by verbal confirmation on the frequency on the consumption of firewood in the baseline and is then followed by KPT. Please refer to CL #8 for details.
	Calibration frequency /interval:	NA, as the survey data is obtained by verbal confirmation on the frequency on the consumption of firewood in the baseline and is then followed by KPT.
	Is the calibration interval in line with the monitoring plan and/or methodology? If the monitoring plan does not specify the frequency of calibration, is the selected frequency in accordance with the local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specifications?	N/A, as no monitoring/measuring equipment used.
	Is the calibration of measuring equipment carried out by an accredited person or institution?	N/A, as no monitoring/measuring equipment used.
	Is(are) calibration(s) valid for the whole reporting period?	N/A, as no monitoring/measuring equipment used.
	How were the values in the monitoring report verified?	VVB has reviewed the baseline surveys and KPTs. Data analysis on survey data concluded that the value is calculated accordingly. Data Traceability for the survey data presented was carried out during opening meeting.
	If applicable, has the reported data been cross checked with other available data?	N/A. BCB,i,y is surveyed and updated in accordance with section 9.2 of the updated methodology.

	Does the data management ensure correct transfer of data and reporting of emission reductions and are necessary QA/QC processes in place?	The approach PP has implemented based on the questionnaire format of the survey, data interpretation and analysis for precision level, it is concluded to satisfy methodology requirement ^{7/} . The approach resulted in simplified questionnaires that is easily conveyed by survey team and understood by survey participants. The calculation of the value of itself is also simple fraction based on the frequency. Please refer to CL #8 for details.
	In case project participants have temporarily not monitored the parameter, has either deviation?	N/A. BCB,i,y is surveyed and updated in accordance with section 9.2 of the updated methodology.
Findings	CL#8	
Conclusion	The raised CLs were resolved satisfactorily. The value of this parameter is verified and accepted as: 4.04 tonnes/year	

5. Parameter BCP,j,k,y (Fuel used per project device type i during year y)

Means of verification	Measuring /Reading /Recording frequency	Following methodology ⁷⁷ requirement, the parameter is to be obtained from survey biennial or annually. The parameter is to be monitored using 2 options with option 1 being used. This option requires measurement campaign followed by KPTs that are not the part of the project activity. CDM CDM Standard for Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and Programmes of Activities sampling procedures were followed for project scenario achieved confidence and precision of at 95/10 for the target parameter of average daily fuel consumption per adult equivalent. 126 samples in the project scenario were surveyed followed by 116 KPTs. The fuel consumption was confirmed by interviews of baseline households during onsite visit. The monitoring frequency is in line with updated methodology. The verification team would like to highlight that during the course of the verification process, Verra raised comments through the Project Review Report (PRR). In reference to Comment #8 concerning the Baseline reassessment and KPT, the detailed baseline reassessment is provided by the verification team in section 3.4 of the FVR. For detailed assessment kindly refer this section.
	Is measuring and reporting frequency in accordance with the monitoring plan and monitoring methodology? (Yes / No)	Following methodology ⁷⁷ requirement, under option 1 the parameter is to be obtained from survey designed to capture the cooking habits and project activity firewood consumption of households.

		Assessment team has reviewed the sampling approach and the project survey data. The estimate wood consumption in the project was confirmed by project households during onsite visit. The approach PP has implemented based on the questionnaire format of the survey, data interpretation and analysis for precision level, it is concluded to satisfy methodology requirement⁷¹.
	Monitoring equipment	NA, as the survey data is obtained by verbal confirmation and is followed by KPT.
	Is accuracy of the monitoring equipment as stated in the monitoring plan? If the monitoring plan does not specify the accuracy of the monitoring equipment, does the accuracy of the monitoring equipment comply with local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specification?	NA, as the survey data is obtained by verbal confirmation on the frequency on the consumption of firewood in the project and is then followed by KPT.
	Calibration frequency /interval:	NA, as the survey data is obtained by verbal confirmation on the frequency on the consumption of firewood in the project and is then followed by KPT.
	Is the calibration interval in line with the monitoring plan and/or methodology? If the monitoring plan does not specify the frequency of calibration, is the selected frequency in accordance with the local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specifications?	N/A, as no monitoring/measuring equipment used.
	Is the calibration of measuring equipment carried out by an accredited person or institution?	N/A, as no monitoring/measuring equipment used.

	Is(are) calibration(s) valid for the whole reporting period?	N/A, as no monitoring/measuring equipment used.
	How were the values in the monitoring report verified?	VVB has reviewed the project KPTs. Data analysis on survey data concluded that the value is calculated accordingly. Data Traceability for the survey data presented was carried out during opening meeting.
	If applicable, has the reported data been cross checked with other available data?	N/A. BCp,j,k,y is surveyed and updated in accordance with section 9.2 of the updated methodology.
	Does the data management ensure correct transfer of data and reporting of emission reductions and are necessary QA/QC processes in place?	The approach PP has implemented based on the questionnaire format of the survey, data interpretation and analysis for precision level, it is concluded to satisfy methodology requirement ^{7/} . The approach resulted in simplified questionnaires that is easily conveyed by survey team and understood by survey participants. The calculation of the value of itself is also simple fraction based on the frequency.
	In case project participants have temporarily not monitored the parameter, has either deviation?	N/A. BCp,j,k,y is surveyed and updated in accordance with section 9.2 of the updated methodology.
Findings	N/A	
Conclusion	VVB reviewed monitoring survey and Project KPTs. VVB analysed sampling calculation The value of this parameter is verified and accepted as: 1.21 tonnes/year	

5. Parameter $\eta_{new,avg,y}$ (Weighted average efficiency of project devices in year y)

Means of verification	Measuring /Reading /Recording frequency	Following methodology ^{7/} requirement, the parameter is established by Water Boiling Test campaigns achieving 90/10 confidence and precision levels as per the most recent version of the CDM Standard for Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and Programmes of Activities. The monitoring have to be performed on annual bases. Please refer to CL #13
	Is measuring and reporting frequency in accordance with the monitoring plan and monitoring methodology? (Yes / No)	Following methodology ^{7/} requirement, the parameter is established by Water Boiling Test campaigns achieving 90/10 confidence and precision levels as per the most recent version of the CDM Standard for Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and Programmes of Activities. The monitoring have to be performed on annual bases. Please refer to CL #13
	Monitoring equipment	N/A . Lab test was performed for 13 samples. Samples were selected to achieve 90/10 confidence and precision levels as per the most recent version of the CDM Standard for Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and Programmes of Activities. The monitoring have to be performed on annual bases. Please refer to CL #13
	Is accuracy of the monitoring equipment as stated in the monitoring plan? If the monitoring plan does not specify the accuracy of the monitoring equipment, does the accuracy of the monitoring equipment comply with local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specification?	PP submitted WBT reports for 13 samples. These are lab authenticated documents. Please see CL #13 for further details

	Calibration frequency /interval:	N/A as the parameter is tested in lab annually.
	Is the calibration interval in line with the monitoring plan and/or methodology? If the monitoring plan does not specify the frequency of calibration, is the selected frequency in accordance with the local/national standards, or as per the manufacturer's specifications?	N/A.
	Is the calibration of measuring equipment carried out by an accredited person or institution?	N/A.
	Is(are) calibration(s) valid for the whole reporting period?	N/A.
	How were the values in the monitoring report verified?	Data analysis is performed with the presented project distribution database. Please refer to CL #13 for details
	If applicable, has the reported data been cross checked with other available data?	N/A the parameter value is calculated based on weighted average of efficiency of 13 tested samples selected to achieve 90/10 confidence and precision levels as per the most recent version of the CDM Standard for Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project Activities and Programmes of Activities.
	Does the data management ensure correct transfer of data and reporting of emission reductions and are necessary QA/QC processes in place?	The third party WBT reports are submitted. Please refer to CL #13 for details
	In case project participants have temporarily not monitored the parameter, has either deviation?	N/A
Findings	CL #13	

Conclusion	The raised CLs were resolved satisfactorily.		
	The value of this parameter is verified and accepted as:		
	Kuniokoa Efficiency value		
	With pot skirt	Without pot skirt	
	0.4861	0.4095	
	Monitored Utilization of Pot-skirt	Final $\eta_{new,i,j}$	Weighted Average
89.57%	0.4781		

Full assessment of value and data used in ER calculation is verified as detailed above. Clarifications and inconsistencies raised as CLs and CARs have been resolved as provided in each specific parameter.

The assessment team has thoroughly verified the calculation done for the quantification of the emissions reduction for the project activity, under this monitoring period from 01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024.

4.4 Quality of Evidence to Determine Reductions and Removals

Verification team was able to confirm that the data presented is able to be traced to initial raw source of record/data. The spreadsheets used to calculate the VCU calculations, and all figures were tracked, checked and found to be consistent.

The transfer of carbon rights and other supporting documents related to quality and maintenance were checked by the verification team during the remote audit assessment to confirm the authenticity of the documents and to check the correctness of the calculation.

The verification team can confirm that sufficient evidence is available for the whole monitoring period and the same is verifiable. Based on the distribution database, 335,313 were distributed (out of 202,965 units distributed in the MP2). The follow up household visit is for collection is to collect information including type of baseline stove which is used to determine value of monitored parameter nold value. Verifier team evaluated the approach chosen by PP to be acceptable from the conservativeness principle as well while still meeting the requirement of the applied methodology.

In accordance with the above details the verification team confirms that:

A complete set of data for the monitoring period was available for the monitoring period and the verification of each monitoring parameter is elaborated under this of this report.

The complete monitoring data is also presented in the corresponding ER sheet and the final monitoring report.

The information provided in the monitoring report was cross checked with other sources, wherever appropriate and available, and such information is also included under this of this report.

The calculations of baseline emissions as presented in the corresponding ER sheet of final Monitoring Report were checked and found to be consistent with the formulae and methods described in the registered monitoring plan/05/ and the applied methodology.

All assumptions used in the emission calculations were found appropriate and therefore justified.

Appropriate emission factors and other reference values have been correctly applied.

The assessment team has verified all the primary supporting related to operations, quality, and generation of data during the monitoring period such as cross verification against initial/raw data source (users' signed agreements/14/, internal database record for distribution database for user's information, baseline stove and fuel type/11/; monitoring survey/12/ and; technical specification of ICS model/26/, training sessions for competence evaluation of monitoring personals and survey execution guidance/22/, data quality check for plausibility and accuracy, VVB verified the 4.3.3 and 4.3.4 section of the MR in relation to QA/QC measures and training in relation to the competence of the field team. Evidence provided in form of internal audit reports, training records, project stove training material used for households visit/training/30/.

ER calculation with formulations and units conversion as well as data transfer from data sources into reports. The photographs were only used as means of secondary cross check of the information verified from Primary sources. As this is the 2nd monitoring period of the project's first crediting period, information regarding project capacity commission and monitoring system are already verified in previous monitoring report which are also cross checked with previous report. Thus, a reasonable level of assurance is achieved.

4.5 Non-Permanence Risk Analysis

VCS standard/1/ section 2.4, non-permanence risk analysis is applicable for Agriculture, Forestry, and Other Land Use (AFOLU) and Geologic Carbon Storage (GCS) projects.

5 VERIFICATION OPINION

5.1 Verification Summary

The project activity VCS – 3699, “DelAgua Improved Cookstove Grouped Project” has undergone 2nd verification with monitoring period from 01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024 (including both days). DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) is responsible for the collection, analysis, aggregation, preparation (conversion factors, assumptions, methodology, calculations) and presentation of activities and related GHG data in its public disclosures (including but not limited to monitoring report, emission reduction calculation sheet, submitted documents/ emails/ communications). Our responsibility of performing this work is to the management of DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) and in accordance with terms of reference agreed with the DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) in the master service agreement. The verification engagement is based on the assumption that the GHG data provided to us is complete, sufficient, true and free from material misstatements. SustainCERT disclaims any liability or co-responsibility for any decision a person or an entity would make based on this verification statement towards the issuance and utilization of VCU's hereby verified and certified. The verification was carried out during March – May 2025 by a team of qualified GHG auditors.

SustainCERT applies its own quality management system and compliance policies for quality control, in accordance with ISO/IEC 17029:2019 – Conformity Assessment Requirements for Validation and Verification bodies providing environmental information (ISO 14065:2020) and greenhouse gas audit (ISO 14064-3:2019) and certifications, and accordingly maintains a comprehensive system of quality control including documented policies and procedures regarding compliance with ethical requirements, professional standards and applicable legal & regulatory requirements.

We have complied with the VCS standard/1/ and other requirements mentioned, during the verification engagement and maintained independence. SustainCERT was not involved in the preparation of any statements or reports or data except for this Verification Statement and Report. SustainCERT maintains complete impartiality toward stakeholders interviewed during the verification process. SustainCERT did not provide any services to DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) (current Project Proponent) & DelAgua Health Rwanda Voluntary Limited (previous Project Proponent) and its subsidiaries in the scope of verification that could compromise the independence or impartiality of our work.

International Accreditation Forum accreditation body approved validation/verification body opinions must include a declaration that the validation and/or verification of the GHG statement was conducted in accordance with ISO 14064-3. The applicable ISO version must be included (e.g., ISO 14064-3: 2019).

5.2 Verification Conclusion

The Verification of the project titled ‘DelAgua Improved Cookstove Grouped Project’ VCS ID – 3699, have been undertaken by SustainCERT, as requested by DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS), project proponent for the monitoring period 01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024 (including both the days) as reported in monitoring report/8/. The project activity is implemented in accordance with the registered monitored plan in PD/5/ and the emission reduction from the project activity. It is our responsibility to express an independent verification statement on the reported GHG emission reductions from the project activity.

SustainCERT Verification approach was based on understanding the risk associated with reporting of GHG emission data and the controls in place to mitigate these. SustainCERT planned and performed the verification by obtaining evidence and other information and explanations that SustainCERT considered necessary to give reasonable assurance that reported GHG emission reductions are fairly stated.

In our opinion, the GHG emissions reductions reported for the project activity for the period 01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024 are fairly stated in the project monitoring report/8/. The GHG emission reductions were calculated correctly based on the approved baseline and monitoring methodology VM0050-EE-and-Fuel-Switch-Measures-in-Cookstoves-v1.0 and the monitoring plan contained in the PD/5/ and updated methodology.

Verification period: From 01/01/2023 – 31/12/2024

Verified GHG emission reductions and carbon dioxide removals in the above verification period:

Vintage period	Baseline emissions (tCO ₂ e)	Project emissions (tCO ₂ e)	Leakage emissions (tCO ₂ e)	Reduction VCUs (tCO ₂ e)	Removal VCUs (tCO ₂ e)	Total VCUs (tCO ₂ e)
01-Jan-2023 to 31-Dec-2023	1,422,299	446,211	0	927,283	0	927,283
01-Jan-2024 to 31-Dec-2024	1,509,444	473,550	0	984,099	0	984,099

Total	2,931,743	919,761	0	1,911,382	0	1,911,382
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5.3 Ex-ante vs Ex-post ERR Comparison

Vintage period	Ex-ante estimated reductions/removals	Achieved reductions/removals	Percent difference	Explanation for the difference
01-Jan-2023 to 31-Dec-2023	1,045,259	927,283	~11% lower	There is a 7 % difference in the ex-ante estimates and the actual emission reductions obtained for this monitoring period. The lower ER achieved is observed due to the lower ICS distribution than envisaged ex-ante and distribution of ICS in phases and portion of the user with baseline stove efficiency of 0.2 for those of categorized as non-three stone fire. Therefore, lead to a difference in the estimates and actuals for the ERs/VCUs. .
01-Jan-2024 to 31-Dec-2024	1,015,981	984,099	~3% lower	
Total	2,061,240	1,911,382	~7% lower	

APPENDIX 1: COMMERCIALLY SENSITIVE INFORMATION

<i>Section</i>	<i>Information</i>	<i>Justification</i>	<i>Assessment conclusion</i>	<i>method</i>	<i>and</i>
N/A					

APPENDIX 2: TABLE OF REFERENCE

S. No	Document Title	Version	Date
1	VCS standard https://verra.org/documents/vcs-standard-v4-7/	4.7	16/04/2024
2	VCS guidelines https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/08/VCS-Program-Guide-v4.4.pdf	4.4	29/08/2023
3	Validation and Verification Manual https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/VCS_Validation_Verification_Manual_v3.2.pdf	3.2	19/10/2016
4	VCS Project Webpage, VCS ID - 3699 (https://registry.verra.org/app/projectDetail/VCS/3699)		
5	Joint Project Description & Monitoring Report MP1 Document 'JPDMR_3699_v6_clean' (https://registry.verra.org/mymodule/ProjectDoc/Project_ViewFile.asp?FileID=107650&IDKEY=akjalskjf098234kj28098sfkjlf098098kl32lasjdfkj909j148449350)	6.0	03/12/2023
6	Joint Validation and Verification (MP1) report 'VCS.VAL.23.33_DelAgua_FVR_15122023_Clean' (https://registry.verra.org/mymodule/ProjectDoc/Project_ViewFile.asp?FileID=107743&IDKEY=l0e98hfalksuf098fnsdaIfkjfoijmn4309JLKJfJlaksjfla9l148577597)	2.1	14/12/2023
7	Updated Methodology: VM0050 ENERGY EFFICIENCY AND FUEL-SWITCH MEASURES IN COOKSTOVES	1.0	
8	Monitoring report MP2 (01/01/2023 to 31/12/2024)	5.0	21-August-2025
9	Emission reduction calculation sheet VCS 3699 MP2 ER Calculator v 3.0 11072025'	3.0	11/07/2025
10	Onsite audit report (18/03/2025 – 21/03/2025)		
11	Project distribution and controlled household database '9.0 VCS 3699 ICS Distribution Database' (Confidential) Project distribution and controlled household database '9.0 VCS 3699 ICS Distribution Database' (public version)		11/07/2025
12	Monitoring Survey VCS 3699 MP2 ER Calculator v3.0 11072025'	3.0	11/07/2025

S. No	Document Title	Version	Date
13	Project platform data collection and retention		Accessed on 18/03/2025
14	User's signed agreements		
15	KML files for Burera, Huye, Karongi, Kirehe, Ngoma, Nyagatare, Nyamasheke, Nyaruguru, Rubavu, Rusizi, Rwamagana, Gekenke, Nyabihu, Nyamagabe, and Rubavu district		
16	DeAgua internal policy and employment handbook: CHSS Policy – Rwanda Risk Register _ Rwanda Signed Employee Handbook – Rwanda Approved Code of Conduct-CBW Anti Child and Modern Slavery signed statements Signed Code of Conduct		
17	Sampling and surveys for CDM project activities and programmes of activities https://cdm.unfccc.int/Reference/Standards/index.html	9	
18	No Double counting declaration Agreement with Burn Manufacturing and PP related to ownership and double counting.		
19	UN List of Least Developed Country (https://unfccc.int/topics/resilience/workstreams/national-adaptation-programmes-of-action/ldc-country-information).		Accessed on 01/04/2025
20	DeAgua field team activity log records		
21	Attendance list for training sessions field team		
22	Rwanda Labor Law (https://webapps.ilo.org/dyn/travail/docs/530/rwanda_)		
23	Kuniokoa Stove Purchase Order		
24	2006 IPCC Guidelines for National Greenhouse Gas Inventories; Chapter 2 Stationary Combustion	2006	

S. No	Document Title	Version	Date
25	Burns Website (product specification) Kuniokoa https://www.burnstoves.com/products/wood-stoves/kuniokoa/		Accessed on 22/04/2025
26	CDM Guideline Sampling and Surveys for CDM Project4 Activities and PoA	4	16/10/2015
27	VCS Methodology Requirements	4.4	29/08/2023
28	Local Stakeholder Consultation records: --District collaboration agreements -LSC report in district level -Sampled invitation		2022
29	Training evidences for monitoring team: -CHWs Attendance list -Household Visit photo -Tubeho Neza Flipbook UPDATE 2019 V5 (Training Material) -MS Training Attendance -Training Photo (monitoring survey team) -1.0 SDG 8 - List of Employees – Rwanda VCS3699 ICS Continuous Engagement_Household Visits_Report		
30	Rwanda environmental laws and regulations: 1. Law No. 04/2005 2. Ministerial Order No. 003/2008 Ministerial Order No. 004/2008 4. General Guidelines and procedure for EIA (https://elaw.org/resource/rwanda-environmental-impact-assessment-law-and-regulations)		Accessed 22/04/2025
31	Rwanda Clean Cooking Initiatives: Clean Cooking Results-based Financing (CC-RBF) (https://www.reg.rw/what-we-do/rbf-programs/rbf-clean-cooking/)		Accessed 22/04/2025

S. No	Document Title	Version	Date
32	Rwanda 7 Years Government Programme: National Strategy for Transformation (NST1) 2017–2024 <u>National Strategy For Trsansformation -NST1.pdf (minaloc.gov.rw)</u>		Accessed 22/04/2025
33	Rwanda (country profiles) from ILO database <u>International Labour Standards country profile: Rwanda (ilo.org)</u>		Accessed 22/04/2025
34	WBT reports and WBT calculation sheet.		
35	Baseline survey and Baseline KPTs raw data and analysis sheet.		
36	Product Factsheet_manufacturer's specs		
37	Project 3699 LoA		
38	National Survey on Cooking Fuel Energy and Technologies		
39	Project stove purchase order (Burn Invoice)		
40	Project stove KPT raw data and analysis sheet.		
41	Revised PD (1.0 VCS3699_PD ver 11.0 21082025_TC)	11	21-August-2025
42	Grievance Register (GRM - 3699 - LIVE_Grievance Register)		01/01/2023-31/12/2024
43	Signed MoU between Government of Rwanda and DelAgua-Oct 2021 (Confidential)	-	-
44	Carbon Operations Manual (Confidential)	-	-
45	VERRA Clarification Mail on Control Households Requirement in VM0050	15-August-2025	

APPENDIX 3: ABBREVIATIONS

MR	Monitoring report
PD	Project description
MP	Monitoring Period
PP	Project Proponent
PAI	Project Instances
ICS	Improved Cook Stove
VCS	Verified Carbon Standard
SDG	Sustainable Development Goals
VCU	Verified Carbon Unit
IPCC	Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
AQI	Acceptable Quality Level
UQL	Unacceptable Quality Level
GP	Grouped Project
CHW	Community Health Worker

APPENDIX 4: PROJECT FINDINGS

PD for methodology change

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CAR 1	Developer Response
PD template guide v 4.4	Summary Description of the Project	In accordance with section 1.1 of the PD template guide PP shall ensure that summary of the project description is not beyond one page of the document.	Section 1.1 of the PD has been revised to ensure the project description summary is within one page, in line with the PD template guide.
	Round-2	PP has Updated section 1.1 of PD limiting project description summary within one page in accordance with PD template guide v 4.4. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 1	Developer Response
	Project location evidence	Section1.5.1 PP shall submit geodetic polygons file of defined PAI geographical area in line with section 3.6.10 of the VCS standard v 4.7 PP shall provide KML file for the geographic area where project is located VVB could not sight the details on the location including list of districts villages where project is active in line with section 2.6.12 of VCS standard v 4.7. PP shall clarify appropriately.	The project boundary for the grouped project is defined as the geographic borders of Rwanda, as outlined in the registered PD. The boundary for each Project Activity Instance (PAI) is the physical, geographical location of the improved cookstoves (ICS) distributed within Rwanda. As of the end of this monitoring period, the grouped project includes only one PAI, which falls entirely within the geographical boundary of the grouped project. In line with Section 3.6.10 of the VCS

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 1	Developer Response
			Standard v4.7, a KML file representing the grouped project boundary (i.e., the geographic borders of Rwanda) is being submitted. Further, to align with Section 2.6.12 of the VCS Standard v4.7, separate KML files for each district where distribution has occurred or is planned are also being submitted. These files indicate the physical, geographical locations of ICS distributions across Rwanda. During the registration phase, the grouped project boundary and individual district-level KML files were submitted to the VVB, validated, and subsequently approved by Verra. The grouped project boundary KML file is also accessible on the Verra registry page for project ID 3699. The same files are being submitted again to the VVB for reference.
	Round-2	Justification submitted by PP is acceptable by VVB as it is already validated and registered that project stoves are distributed within Rwanda. For current MP there is only one PAI which is well placed in the project boundary. #CLOSED PP has submitted KML file for VVB review and the location of PAI are already validated and registered in PDMR. Hence this finding is closed. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 2	Developer Response
VCS Standard v4.7	Evidence of ownership and collaboration	Section 1.6 and 1.7 PP shall provide documentary evidence of ownership and collaboration between mentioned Project proponent and other entities involved in the project in accordance with section 3.7.1 of VCS Standard v 4.7. In addition to this VVB could not sight defined roles and responsibilities for both the entities. PP shall clarify.	DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS) is the Project Proponent (PP) and holds the full ownership of the carbon rights for the project. As documentary evidence of project ownership, a declaration signed by the PP confirming no double counting under the project and affirming the carbon rights (<i>named Project 3699 Assignment of Carbon Rights Agreement - 2025-03-12 - signed w IDs</i>) for Project ID 3699 is being submitted. There is no formal agreement between DelAgua Health Rwanda (Implementation) Limited (DHRI) and DATAS specific to Project 3699. However, DHRI functions as the operational entity responsible for on-ground implementation and field-level activities in Rwanda. In contrast, DATAS is the investment and sales entity and retains all carbon rights associated with the project. To document this relationship, the PP has created and is submitting a <i>Project Development Agreement</i> that outlines the defined roles and responsibilities of both entities. Section 1.7 of the PD has been updated to reflect the defined roles and responsibilities of both entities in line with section 3.7.1 of the VCS Standard v4.7.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 2	Developer Response
	Round-2	PP has submitted 'Project 3699 - Project Developer Agreement 2025-04-17 – signed' between DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. and DelAgua Health Rwanda (Implementation) Limited. The documents detail out the scope of work, project developer obligations and project implementation obligation. PP has also submitted 'Project 3699 Assignment of Carbon Rights Agreement - 2025-03-12 - signed w IDs' that clarify on carbon rights ownership.	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 2	Developer Response
		DelAgua Trans Africa Stoves Pte. Ltd. (DATAS), is a wholly owned subsidiary within the DelAgua Group, similar to the original project proponent. DelAgua Health Rwanda Voluntary Limited. These project proponents are created to facilitate investment and sales, without affecting the operational delivery of the project. The evidence of change in form of Deed of Accession and Deed of Partial Release in Respect of VCS Listing Deed of Representation, both signed on the 28 Dec 2023 is submitted to VVB. From the project database information, the units credited has the last distributed date on the 27 July 2023 which is in prior to the timeline in which change of PP was initiated. All of the total 335,313 units of stoves credited with signed users agreements are valid referring to DelAgua Health Rwanda Voluntary Ltd which can be transferred as stated as part of the user agreement's declaration template. This addresses the FAR raised in previous verification as well #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 3	Developer Response
ER spreadsheet	ER Projection	Section 1.11 VVB could not sight appropriate ER projection calculation in ER Spreadsheet which is in accordance with section 1.11 of the PD.	Please refer to the tab titled “Distribution Plan & ER Summary” in the Ex-ante ER spreadsheet named “2.0 VCS 3699 VM0050 Ex-ante ER Calculator v2.0 24032025” which has already been submitted as part of the project documentation. This tab provides the ER projection calculations in accordance with Section 1.11 of the PD.
	Round-2	VVB confirms the projected ER values are now inline with section 1.11 of the PD. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 4	Developer Response									
	Project stove specification	Section 1.12 PP shall provide documentary evidence of the design of the stove distributed along with the efficiency test performed for the stove. Further PP shall clarify on how the efficiency of project stove is better than baseline stove in the PD	The PP has already submitted the Product Fact Sheet and CREEC certificates, which confirm the design and efficiency performance of the Improved Cookstoves (ICS) distributed under the project. The documented efficiency values for the respective models are as follows: <table><tr><th>ICS Model</th><th>Efficiency with Pot-skirt</th><th>Efficiency without Pot-skirt</th></tr><tr><td>Kuniokoa</td><td>51.30%</td><td>43.40%</td></tr><tr><td>Ecoa Wood</td><td>52.00%</td><td>45.50%</td></tr></table> These values have been validated by the VVB and approved by Verra, as referenced in Section 1.12 of the registered PD.	ICS Model	Efficiency with Pot-skirt	Efficiency without Pot-skirt	Kuniokoa	51.30%	43.40%	Ecoa Wood	52.00%	45.50%
ICS Model	Efficiency with Pot-skirt	Efficiency without Pot-skirt										
Kuniokoa	51.30%	43.40%										
Ecoa Wood	52.00%	45.50%										

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 4	Developer Response
			As detailed in Section 3.4 of the PD, the baseline stove used by the target population is predominantly a three-stone fire or traditional wood stove. In accordance with the applied methodology VM0050, the efficiency of such baseline technologies is 0.15. Therefore, the efficiency of the project stoves is demonstrably higher than that of the baseline technology, in compliance with the requirements of the methodology.
	Round-2	PP has submitted Project fact sheet, KIRDI report_Burn Kuniokoa without PS, CREEC certificate with PotSkirt. These documents are found to be appropriate as efficiency of the project stoves are clearly mentioned in these documents PP has applied baseline efficiency to be 15% which is less than project stove. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 5	Developer Response
VM0050 v 1.0	Project boundary	Section 1.13 In accordance with Section 5 of the applied methodology PP shall clarify on if project boundary include location from where baseline and project fuel is sourced.	Section 1.13 has been revised to include details on the location from which both baseline and project fuels are sourced. The fuel used in both baseline and project devices is collected or purchased locally, either from nearby fields or local markets situated within the project boundary. This is supported by the data presented in column BP of the Baseline KPT Raw Data sheet. The information on fuel source was collected during the baseline surveys/KPTs in line with the requirements outlined in the VM0050 methodology.
	Round-2	PP has appropriately revised MR to clarify on fuel source used for both baseline and project stove. In addition to this PP has submitted KPT spreadsheets confirms that households either purchase wood from local market or collect form local area within project boundary. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 6	Developer Response
MR template guide v 4.4	Double counting and double claiming	Section 1.15 ,1.16 and 1.17	PP confirms that the grouped project activity and its PAIs: are neither registered nor under the process of registration as a project activity instance as a carbon offset program/mechanism and have no other binding limits. are not deregistered project activities from any carbon offset program/mechanism.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 6	Developer Response
		PP shall provide confirmation whether project is currently active in any other environment schemes and claiming credits. PP shall provide signed declaration stating that the project is not registered with any other registry. In case PP have received or are seeking credit for reductions and removals from a project activity under the VCS Program and another GHG program, PP shall provide the required information as per VCS Standard v4.7 para 3.23.2 (1)-(4). In addition to this PP shall confirm if project is or will be the part of NDCs of the host country.	are not rejected by other GHG Programmes have never been excluded from a registered project under any carbon offset programme/mechanism. are not availing other forms of environmental credit for the concerned crediting period. are not utilising net GHG emission reductions or removals generated during the concerned monitoring period for compliance under any other such carbon offset programme/mechanism. A signed declaration (<i>named - Project 3699 declaration 2025-03-26 – signed</i>) confirming the above is being submitted. Additionally, the PP confirms that project VCS3699 has received an LOA from the Government of Rwanda (GoR), with the terms of the LOA that 10% of credits generated by this project will go directly to the GoR for use towards their NDC. This LOA has been included as supporting evidence (<i>named - Project 3699 LoA</i>). Once credits are issued under this project, ERs will be included in the next BTR from the GoR, due 2027.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 6	Developer Response
			As of now, there is no requirement in the host country for cookstove projects to be included within its NDC framework.
	Round-2	PP has submitted 'Project 3699 declaration 2025-03-26 – signed' and 'Project 3699 LoA'. PP has provided details on double accounting, double claiming and NDCs. The clarification and the documents are found satisfactory by VVB. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 7	Developer Response
		PP shall provide documentary evidence on protocols followed to ensure safety of women and girls, minorities and marginalized groups including children. In addition to this PP shall provide documentary evidence on how risk on discrimination and sexual harassment is mitigated/prevented.	DelAgua maintains a health, safety & security policy for all staff in Rwanda. PP confirms that all employees, vendors, and suppliers involved in the project have signed employment contracts or code of conduct's, which cover child labor, exploitation of women/girls, discrimination, and sexual harassment. Rwanda staff has signed an act on modern slavery which covers Child labor and Women/Girls exploitation. Sexual harassment and discrimination are talked about in the code of conduct and every employee that has a contract has signed to abide with it. PP confirms that the code of conduct applies to all Community Health Workers involved in this project. The following documents are being submitted under the folder titled "DelAgua Employee Policies":

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 7	Developer Response
			1) Sample CHWs code of conduct, 2) Sample Rwanda staff signed modern slavery act, 3) Rwanda employee handbook 4) DelAgua's code of conduct In addition, DelAgua maintains a risk register (as part of an overall risk management policy) that tracks all risk types (in addition to safety and security.) The risk register and country Health, Safety & Security Plan – Rwanda is being submitted.
	Round-2	VVB has reviewed documents submitted by PP, documents cover security management, health, safety and security of DelAgua personnel. In addition to this DelAgua recognise gender issue related security. Moreover, DelAgua personnel has maintained risk register where various types of risks including financial, operational, safeguarding, context, delivery are recorded, analysed and its treatment plan is strategized. Furthermore, DelAgua maintains anti child and modern slavery statements. This reflects their commitment towards integrity in company framework. DelAgua has maintained employee handbook to educate employees on structured workflow in the company. The submitted documents are satisfactory. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 8	Developer Response
Correction and Clarifications to VM0050 energy efficiency and fuel switch measures in cookstoves, v1.0.	Baseline reassessment	Section 3.4 PP shall provide appropriate latest studies and literature that indicate baseline wood consumption to be approximately 6.75 tonnes/HH/year in accordance with clarification 1 of the Correction and Clarifications to VM0050 energy efficiency and fuel switch measures in cookstoves, v1.0.	The baseline woody biomass consumption value of approximately 6.75 tonnes per household per year is sourced from the “National Survey on Cooking Fuel, Energy and Technologies in Households, Commercial and Public Institutions in Rwanda”, conducted in December 2020. This source is within the five-year limit, in line with Clarification 1 of the <i>Corrections and Clarifications to VM0050, Energy Efficiency and Fuel Switch Measures in Cookstoves, v1.0</i>. Additionally, the same report cites a wood-to-charcoal conversion factor of 8.1 kg of wood per kg of charcoal. If a wood-to-charcoal conversion factor of 8.1 kg is used, the woody biomass consumption in Rwandan households is approximately 8.13 tonnes per year. However, in accordance with VM0050 Section 9.1 (Page 27), the methodology permits the use of a default value of up to 6 tonnes of dry wood per tonne of charcoal, provided the value is substantiated by government-approved or endorsed sources. Therefore, a charcoal conversion factor of 6 tonnes of dry wood has been applied, resulting in a calculated equivalent woody biomass consumption of approximately 6.75 tonnes per household per year. In contrast, the project’s own Kitchen Performance Test (KPT) results yielded a baseline consumption value of 4.04 tonnes per household per year, which is approximately 40% lower than the value derived from the national survey. This supports the conservative nature of the project’s baseline estimation.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 8	Developer Response															
			To further benchmark and validate the results obtained through the KPTs, the table below presents baseline fuel consumption values used in other registered Verra projects in Rwanda: <table><tr><th>Registry</th><th>Project ID</th><th>Geography</th><th>Baseline Fuel Consumption (tonnes/device/year)</th><th>Year of Baseline Assessment</th></tr><tr><td>Verra</td><td>3654</td><td>Rwanda</td><td>6.753</td><td>2020</td></tr><tr><td>Verra</td><td>2380</td><td>Rwanda</td><td>7.635</td><td>2021</td></tr></table> As shown, the fuel consumption value derived through the project's KPT is significantly more conservative than those used in other Verra-registered projects conducted under similar conditions.	Registry	Project ID	Geography	Baseline Fuel Consumption (tonnes/device/year)	Year of Baseline Assessment	Verra	3654	Rwanda	6.753	2020	Verra	2380	Rwanda	7.635	2021
Registry	Project ID	Geography	Baseline Fuel Consumption (tonnes/device/year)	Year of Baseline Assessment														
Verra	3654	Rwanda	6.753	2020														
Verra	2380	Rwanda	7.635	2021														
	Round-2	PP has submitted 'National Survey on Cooking Fuel Energy and Technologies' that clarifies about annual firewood consumption to be 6.57 tons. Whereas, PP has submitted Baseline KPT inline with the claim made for wood consumption to be 4.04 tonne/HH/year. Justification submitted by PP is accepted by VVB. #CLOSED																

MP 2 Verification

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CAR 2	Developer Response
MR Templat e guide v 4.4	Format and template	PP shall ensure the consistent format of 10.5, black, regular (non-italic) Arial or Franklin Gothic Book font is followed in accordance with MR template Guide 4.4	The MR has been revised to ensure a consistent format, using font size 10.5 in black, regular (non-italic) Arial or Franklin Gothic Book, in accordance with the Monitoring Report Template Guide version 4.4.
	Round-2	PP has updated the MR to ensure that format of the document is in accordance with MR template guide v 4.4. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 9	Developer Response
VCS Stand ard v 4.7	Project location	VVB has sighted inconsistency in geo coordinates in MR with respect to PD. PP shall ensure location of the project is appropriately mentioned in the document in accordance with section 3.11 if the VCS Standard v 4.7	The MR has been revised to correct the geographical coordinates and to ensure consistency with the registered PD.
	Round-2	Geographical coordinates are now updated by PP in line with the registered PD. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 10	Developer Response
MR Templ ate guide v 4.4	SDGs Claimed for current MP	Section 1.12	PP conducted monitoring surveys across 126 households during the current monitoring period. Operationally, all users confirmed that they were actively using the improved cookstoves (ICS), indicating continued usage. However, PP has incorporated several quality checks during the monitoring surveys to ensure data integrity and determine the final operational status. These checks can be reviewed in column AM of the 'Usage Survey Data' tab in the ER sheet.
		In accordance with the monitoring survey conducted for the current monitoring period usage rate is capped to 90%. PP shall clarify on how this is reflected for claimed SDGs for current MP.	
		PP has provided an excel spreadsheet that enlists the employees across various regions of the project. PP shall provide documentary evidence that may include employment agreements for sample employees-	
		Consolee Nyirahirwa	
		Bayisenge Marie	
		Nsengiyumva Munyeshyaka	
		Musengimana Floride	
		Uwamungu Chantal	
		Muhawenimana Vestine	
		Emmanuel Bagaragaza	
Mukaruhigiro Marie Solange			
Jean Baptiste Uwihirwe			
Hakizimana Vincent			
		in accordance with the claim made for SDG 8 for the current Monitoring period	One household reported that the stove was not in good condition. As a conservative measure, this sample was considered as 'not in use.' As a result, the actual stove operating fraction was determined to be ~99%, as shown in cell E58 of the 'Sample Size Calculation and Results' sheet. Nevertheless, in line with the VM0050 methodology and its clarifications, the usage rate has been conservatively capped at 90% for the final emission reduction calculations.
			Regarding the SDG claims, the methodology does not require the same 90% cap to be applied to other SDG indicators. Therefore, the actual values derived from the survey results have been reported for the claimed SDGs. It has been ensured that no SDG value exceeds the actual operational usage rate, and additional checks were applied to maintain consistency and accuracy. These checks are reflected in columns BC and CD of the 'Usage Survey Data' tab.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 10	Developer Response
			Signed codes of conduct for the sampled employees, along with the code of conduct template and pay slips from various districts, are being submitted under the folder titled "Evidence of Employment" as documentary evidence in support of the SDG 8 claim for the current monitoring period.
	Round-2	Claimed SDGs are in line with the survey results which give a more realistic view of feedback received from households. Moreover, only SDG 13 (which is capped to 90% stove usage) accounts for ER claims. Hence, justification provided by PP is satisfactory. #CLOSED PP has provided signed employment agreements of the employees requested that were randomly selected from the excel list provided by PP and found to be satisfactory. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 11	Developer Response
	Grievance redress mechanism	Section 2.1.2 and 2.1.4 PP shall provide date of stakeholder consultation in line with requirements of MR Template guide v 4.4 PP shall provide documentary evidence for the grievance log/ register in place for the current MP. In addition to this PP shall demonstrate how is continuous engagement of stakeholders is ensured in the current MP	Section 2.1.2 of the MR has been revised to include the date of the stakeholder consultation, in line with the MR Template Guidelines version 4.4. Section 2.1.4 of the MR has been revised to include detailed information on the grievance redressal procedure and continuous stakeholder engagement during the current monitoring period. The grievance register <i>titled GRM - 3699 - LIVE_Grievance Register</i> is being submitted as documentary evidence.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 11	Developer Response
			The PP has established a comprehensive grievance redressal mechanism to ensure that stakeholders have access to a transparent and easily accessible system for ongoing consultation and resolution of project-related concerns. Key aspects of the process are as follows: Grievance Registration: Stakeholders, including end users, can raise grievances through multiple channels: Submitting grievances via the company's website: https://www.delagua.org/Contactus/ Raising issues in person at the field level, which are then escalated by the relevant field personnel to the designated grievance manager. Calling the toll-free helpline dedicated to grievance reporting. Field-Level Escalation Mechanism: During the onsite visit, stakeholders confirmed that Community Health Workers (CHWs), who serve as field staff and local resource persons, act as intermediaries for reporting grievances. These individuals escalate concerns raised by project beneficiaries within their zones. As confirmed by households during the visit, DelAgua conducts regular household visits—aiming for at least one per year—during which staff engage directly with stakeholders and ensure grievances are documented and addressed. If a grievance is brought to a local staff member, they are instructed to escalate it to their line manager, who logs the grievance at the local office.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments # CL 11	Developer Response
			Grievance Logbook and Periodic Visits: A grievance logbook is maintained at the local office in Kigali, Rwanda. Field staff conduct regular visits to project households, providing an additional opportunity for stakeholders to communicate concerns directly. These procedures support effective communication, ensure continuous engagement with stakeholders, and reinforce the project's commitment to transparency, inclusivity, and timely resolution of concerns.
	Round-2	PP has added the date of stakeholder consultation in section 2.1.2 of the MR in accordance with requirements of MR Template guide v 4.4. #CLOSED PP has submitted 'GRM - 3699 - LIVE_Grievance Register'. VVB has reviewed the list of grievances listed and their status. The grievance is mainly related to the operation department. There were no major complaints/feedback recorded for current MP. In addition to this justification provided by PP for continuous stakeholder engagement is acceptable by VVB #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 12	Developer Response
MR Templ ate guide v 4.4	Risk assessment	Section 2.2.2 PP shall clarify if any instance of household displacement has happened during the project monitoring period. If yes then how the usage status of the project stoves were ensured. PP shall provide work condition risk register which is updated on quarterly bases by the project employees for current MP.	During the current monitoring period, no instances of household displacement have been reported under the project. Therefore, this requirement is not applicable. The work condition risk register, which is maintained and updated on a quarterly basis by project staff, is being submitted for the current monitoring period.
	Round-2	1. clarification on instances of house displacement provided by PP is accepted by VVB #CLOSED 2. PP has submitted risk register where various types of risks including financial, operational, safeguarding, context, delivery are recorded, analysed and its treatment plan is strategized for current MP. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 13	Developer Response
	Procedures involved for WBT and usage rate determination	Section 4.2	The PP has submitted the CREEC certificates corresponding to the efficiency values registered as manufacturer-declared values, as outlined in Section 1.12 of the PD.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 13	Developer Response
Correction and Clarifications to VM0050 energy efficiency and fuel switch measures in cookstoves, v1.0		PP has shared documentary evidence for WBT 'CREEC certificate with PotSkirt' for the samples dated 25 May 2018 and KIRDI report_Burn Kuniokoa without PS dated 04TH SEPTEMBER 2019. PP shall clarify on how sampling is performed for WBT in accordance with clarification 4 of correction and clarifications to VM0050 energy efficiency and fuel switch measures in cookstoves, v1.0 VVB sighted that the usage rate is capped to 90% for ER calculation. In accordance with clarification 2 of correction and clarifications to VM0050 energy efficiency and fuel switch measures in cookstoves, v1.0. PP shall demonstrate How project stoves fully meet the cooking needs of the target population and if households have easily adapted to the project stove cooking. Clarify support activities to ensure effective operation of project stoves which may include providing materials (print, in-person, or video) on how to operate the cookstove to prepare common local foods, how to troubleshoot common operational issues, and how to make minor repairs (including obtaining necessary replacement parts) and provide documentary evidence in support of the clarification. Describe if there are procedures in place to facilitate end users of the project stoves to contact the project proponent to access support. Section 4.3	For the current Monitoring Period, and in accordance with Clarification 4 of the "Corrections and Clarifications to VM0050 Energy Efficiency and Fuel Switch Measures in Cookstoves, v1.0," the PP has conducted sampling for the Water Boiling Test (WBT) following the sampling guidance provided under CDM standards. The minimum required sample size for WBT was calculated accordingly and is presented in the "Sample Size Cal & Results" tab of the Emission Reduction sheet. The WBT was carried out to determine the thermal efficiency of the Improved Cookstoves (ICS), fully aligned with the requirements of VM0050 and its associated clarifications. Furthermore, the WBT Summary tab in the ER sheet includes detailed results, indicating the efficiency values for each ICS unit tested. The WBT Efficiency Calculator and hard copy data collection forms are also being submitted. PP conducted monitoring surveys across 126 households during the current monitoring period. Operationally, all users confirmed that they were actively using the improved cookstoves (ICS), indicating continued adoption and that the stoves fully meet their cooking needs. Several quality checks were also incorporated into the monitoring survey to ensure data integrity and to assess the operational status of the stoves. These checks are applied in column AM of the 'Usage Survey Data' tab in the ER sheet.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 13	Developer Response
		PP shall provide details and documentary evidence on repair and maintenance logged for the project stoves in the current MP. The PP shall provide a comprehensive explanation of the repair and maintenance steps involved for the distributed stoves. Specify whether regular maintenance checks are required and who is responsible for conducting them (e.g., project team, technicians, or end-users). The PP shall clarify whether repair costs are covered under the project or if end-users are responsible for any associated expenses. If costs are applicable, provide details on the cost structure, repair service providers, and financial support mechanisms (if any)	One household reported that the stove was not in good condition. As a conservative approach, this sample was treated as "not in use." As a result, the actual stove operating fraction was determined to be 99%, as shown in cell E58 of the "Sample Size Calculation and Results" sheet. However, in line with Clarification 2 of the Corrections and Clarifications to VM0050 v1.0, the usage rate has been conservatively capped at 90% for the final emission reduction calculations. This confirms that households are using DelAgua stoves for their cooking needs and that they have easily adapted to the technology. a. The findings of the usage surveys and high operational usage rate (99%) clearly demonstrate that the project stoves meet the full cooking needs of the target population, and households have readily adopted the technology. b. PP has ensured support activities are in place to promote the effective operation of project stoves. During the household visits following distribution, the project team provides direct training to each household. As part of this engagement: A poster agreement is signed with each household for carbon rights, which includes a large-format instructional poster showing pictorial guidance on proper ICS usage in both English and the local language. The local field team explains this poster during the visit to ensure users clearly understand the operational steps.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 13	Developer Response
			Additionally, a 16-page flipbook, developed in the local language with pictorial illustrations, is used to demonstrate stove usage, maintenance, and troubleshooting guidance. This visual material supports ongoing learning and helps households understand how to use and maintain the ICS effectively. The End User Agreement template (poster) has already been submitted to the VVB in both English and the local language. However, the flipbook titled <i>“Tubeho Neza Flipbook UPDATE 2019 V5 (Training Material)”</i> is now being submitted under the folder titled “MS & KPT Training Records”. c. Multiple channels are available for households to contact DelAgua and access support. The grievance redressal mechanism ensures that users can easily report issues or seek assistance. Detailed procedures are described in Section 2.1.4 of the MR and have also been addressed in Clarification Response #11.2. These include: A toll-free helpline, Field-level reporting mechanisms through Community Health Workers (CHWs), Web-based grievance submissions via https://www.delagua.org/Contactus/, Direct household visits by field staff, which provide opportunities for in-person consultation and feedback.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 13	Developer Response
			These procedures ensure timely support and demonstrate the project's commitment to ensuring proper stove use and stakeholder engagement. During the current monitoring period, no cases of stove repair or maintenance were reported. However, if such issues arise in the field, end users have multiple channels available to raise their concerns with the PP, as detailed in Section 2.1.4 of the Monitoring Report. These include a toll-free helpline, direct reporting through field staff (CHWs), and an online grievance submission portal. DelAgua, as the project proponent, holds full responsibility for maintaining or replacing the stove in case of any operational issues. If a stove is found to be non-functional or in poor condition during household visits or through any complaint mechanism, DelAgua either replaces the stove or excludes that unit from the emission reduction (ER) claims.

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 13	Developer Response
			No regular preventive maintenance schedule is mandated, as the stoves are designed to be durable with minimal maintenance needs. However, support is readily available when needed. This is also reflected in the high operational status of the stoves, over 99% of ICS units were found to be functional during the surveys. Importantly, there is no cost burden on the end users for repairs or replacements—DelAgua covers all such expenses as part of the project's operational responsibility. This ensures that stove functionality is maintained without financial barriers for beneficiaries, supporting both sustained usage and accurate ER claims.
	Round-2	Section 4.2 For the current monitoring period, PP has submitted WBT evidence for all 13 samples. '2.0 VCS 3699 MP2 ER Calculator v 2.0 24032025' spreadsheet provide details on sample calculation for WBT under tab 'sample size cal & results'. Calculation of efficiency of project stove with and without pot skirt is correctly calculated based on the weighted average of the sample frame size for year 2022 and 2023. Hence the procedure is in accordance with clarification 4 of correction and clarifications VM0050 energy efficiency and fuel switch measures in cookstoves, v1.0. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 13	Developer Response
		PP has submitted end user agreement posters, monitoring survey records, MS training records, Tubebo Neza Flipbook UPDATE 2019 V5 (Training Material) distributed to households, refresh meeting records with households and CHW, and attendance sheet of trainings with project personnel conducted in current monitoring period. The evidence manages the requirements stated under clarification 2 of correction and clarifications to VM0050 energy efficiency and fuel switch measures in cookstoves, v1.0. The evidence and the clarification submitted by PP is accepted by VVB. #CLOSED Section 4.3 PP has submitted 'GRM - 3699 - LIVE_Grievance Register' for current monitoring period. There are no major/material grievance recorded. Hence the document and the justification provided by PP is satisfactory. #CLOSED	

Rule	Assessment Question	Findings/Comments #CL 14	Developer Response
VM0050 V 1.0	fNRB calculation	In accordance with section 9.2 of the applied methodology- One of the following sources must be used for calculation /determination of fNRB The most recent national default value(s) published by UNFCCC Calculated based on CDM TOOL30 and applying an uncertainty discount of 26%	This project was registered in November 2024 and is currently undergoing a project deviation request to adopt the VM0050 methodology. The fNRB value was originally calculated using the latest applicable version of CDM Tool 30 (version 4.0), as detailed in Appendix 2 of the registered PD.

		Default value of the most recent version of CDM TOOL33 PP has determined fNRB value by discounting 26% from fNRB in the registered PDD. PP shall clarify and confirm if the input value used for fNRB calculation is based on latest data available for the host country and is conservative.	The value of 0.91 was derived using the most recent and relevant national data available for the host country, in full accordance with the requirements of CDM Tool 30, version 4.0. The calculation was thoroughly validated by the VVB and subsequently approved by Verra during the registration process. Further, as tabulated in Appendix 2 of the PD, the PP conducted a comparative analysis of fNRB values utilized in other registered projects under both the Verra and Gold Standard frameworks for Rwanda. The fNRB value used by recently registered projects are as follows: <table><tr><th>Registry</th><th>Project ID</th><th>fNRB</th></tr><tr><td>Verra</td><td>2380</td><td>97%</td></tr><tr><td>Gold Standard</td><td>4261</td><td>98%</td></tr><tr><td>Gold Standard</td><td>2450</td><td>98%</td></tr><tr><td>Gold Standard</td><td>11205</td><td>90%</td></tr><tr><td>Gold Standard</td><td>2449</td><td>98%</td></tr><tr><td>Gold Standard</td><td>11098</td><td>96.82%</td></tr></table>	Registry	Project ID	fNRB	Verra	2380	97%	Gold Standard	4261	98%	Gold Standard	2450	98%	Gold Standard	11205	90%	Gold Standard	2449	98%	Gold Standard	11098	96.82%
Registry	Project ID	fNRB																						
Verra	2380	97%																						
Gold Standard	4261	98%																						
Gold Standard	2450	98%																						
Gold Standard	11205	90%																						
Gold Standard	2449	98%																						
Gold Standard	11098	96.82%																						

			<table><tr><td>Gold Standard</td><td>12308</td><td>88.72%</td></tr></table> The f_{NRB} value used in other registered projects across various standards range from 88.72% to 98%. As a measure of conservative, the f_{NRB} value for the project has been changed to 88.72% which the lowest among the all the registered projects. In accordance with Section 9.2 of the applied methodology, and given the transition to the VM0050 methodology, the PP has applied a 26% uncertainty discount to the previously approved value. This approach aligns with the methodological requirements and ensures a conservative and transparent representation of the emission reductions.	Gold Standard	12308	88.72%
Gold Standard	12308	88.72%				
Round-2		Rationale provided by PP regarding adoption of f_{NRB} based on lasted available value is accepted by PP. #CLOSED				

APPENDIX 5: COMPETENCY STATEMENT

COMPETENCY STATEMENT	
Name	Manika Mongia
Years of Experience	4+
QUALIFYING ROLES	
Team Leader	Yes
Auditor	Yes
Country Expert	Yes, CE Region 1 (English) / CE Region 6 (Hindi)
Technical Expert	Yes (TA 1.1)
Financial Expert	No
Independent Reviewer	No
APPROVAL	
Approved by	Head of Quality and Compliance, SustainCERT
Date	27/10/2023

COMPETENCY STATEMENT	
Name	Indrapal Parmar
Years of Experience	15+
QUALIFYING ROLES	
Team Leader	No
Auditor	Yes
Country Expert	Yes, CE Region 1 (English) / CE Region 6 (Hindi)
Technical Expert	Yes (1.1, 1.2, 1.6)
Financial Expert	Yes
Independent Reviewer	Yes
APPROVAL	

Approved by	Head of Quality and Compliance, SustainCERT
Date	15/07/2022

COMPETENCY STATEMENT	
Name	Jean Bosco Rwiyamirira
Years of Experience	1+
QUALIFYING ROLES	
Team Leader	No
Auditor	Yes
Country Expert	Yes, CE Region 1 (English), CE Region 6 (Other language Kinyarwanda, Swahili)
Technical Expert	Yes (1.1)
Financial Expert	No
Independent Reviewer	No
APPROVAL	
Approved by	Head of Quality and Compliance, SustainCERT
Date	05/02/2024

COMPETENCY STATEMENT	
Name	Muskan Chawla
Years of Experience	2+
QUALIFYING ROLES	
Team Leader	Yes
Auditor	Yes
Country Expert	Yes, CE Region 1 (English) / CE Region 6 (Hindi)
Technical Expert	Yes (1.1, 1.2)
Financial Expert	No
Independent Reviewer	Yes

APPROVAL	
Approved by	Head of Quality and Compliance, SustainCERT
Date	05/09/2023